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Artificial is real.
Know AI-related terms and why they matter to investors
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SME IPO mirage: Debut dazzle, long-term damage

BITTER AFTERTASTE. Over 500 SME IPOs from the past decade are under water; 46 per cent of 100x-subscribed issues are trading below offer price

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

India's SME IPO market, with far lighter listing requirements than the mainboard, has rarely lacked takers. How else can one explain frenzied bidding for a two-showroom motorcycle dealer, a regional *chakkhatta* maker or a farming business deriving most of its revenues from pomegranates? Even repeated instances of fund diversion, mismatched accounts and untraceable entities have barely dented investor appetite.

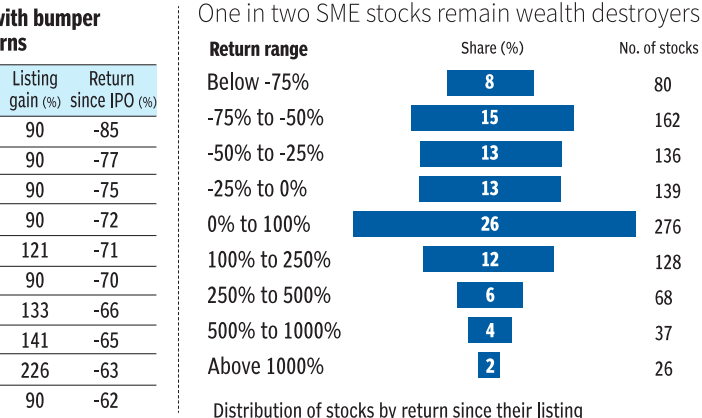
The lure is simple: Spectacular listing gains. That appetite has endured despite a challenging market. Amid geopolitical uncertainty and weak sentiment, just 27 mainboard IPOs have hit the market this year. SME platforms, however, have seen more than three times that number. No mainboard IPO has delivered a 50 per cent listing gain in the past six months.

By contrast, eight SME IPOs have achieved the feat, including three that nearly doubled on debut in the past month alone — making even *Phir Hera Pheri*'s famous “25

Top oversubscribed SME IPOs with bumper listings but poor long-term returns				
SME stock	Subscription (x)	Listing gain (%)	Return since IPO (%)	
Dolphin Kitchen Utensils	513	90	-85	
Manglam Infra	249	90	-77	
Sati Poly	466	90	-75	
Euphoria Infotec	365	90	-72	
Addictive Learn	246	121	-71	
Dindigul Farm	191	90	-70	
Net Avenue	476	133	-66	
Veritaas Advertising	439	141	-65	
Indian Emulsifiers	307	226	-63	
Storage Tech	187	90	-62	

din mein paisa double” promise look conservative.

Yet, beneath the listing-day fireworks lies a sobering reality: Nearly half the SME companies listed over the past decade now trade below their issue price. A *bl.portfolio* analysis of Capitaline data show that 518 of the 1,052 companies listed on the BSE and NSE SME platforms since January 2016 — or 49 per cent — are currently below their offer price. For investors who bought at the offer price and held on, those are uncomfortably close to coin-toss odds. Contrast this with the mainboard where a lower 36 per



Wipe-outs and Blockbusters			
Sector	Total stocks	% of stocks below issue price	% of stocks with >100%**
IT - Software	76	55	22
Trading	74	57	20
Infrastructure Developers	55	44	20
Capital Goods	54	31	46
Textiles	51	61	6
FMCG	49	45	22
Logistics	37	51	27
Chemicals	36	53	22
Pharmaceuticals	32	59	22
Retail	26	46	35

Top sector-wise performance of SME stocks since listing*

Source for raw data: Capitaline; Analyzed by bl.portfolio; Value as of July 9, 2026; *Stocks that were launched since 2016 considered; **Includes sectors with meaningful representation and a high incidence of both negative-return and multibagger stocks; **stocks delivered above 100% return

cent are in the red. The numbers expose the gap between the SME market's fundraising boom and its promise of long-term wealth creation. While some companies have multiplied, post-listing performance has often disappointed, even over longer holding periods.

WINNERS & LAGGARDS

The return profile of SME IPOs is highly polarised. While some companies have created spectacular wealth, many more have delivered disappointing returns. Of the 1,052 SME companies listed since January 2016, 377 (36 per cent) have fallen

more than 25 per cent from their issue price, including 80 that have lost over three-fourths of their value.

At the other end of the spectrum, 259 companies (25 per cent) have more than doubled from their IPO price, including 131 that have generated returns of over 250 per cent.

However, only 63 companies — just 6 per cent of the total universe — have delivered multibagger returns exceeding 500 per cent.

Heavy oversubscription, meanwhile, proved no substitute for due diligence. Of the 294 SME IPOs subscribed

more than 100 times, 134 (46 per cent) now trade below their issue price.

As many as 102 (35 per cent) have fallen more than 25 per cent. Yet, returns remain sharply polarised: 28 per cent have more than doubled, 21 have delivered returns above 500 per cent, and 10 have crossed the 1,000 per cent mark.

Resourceful Automobile exemplifies the phenomenon. Its ₹12-crore IPO was subscribed 396 times, despite the company operating just two Yamaha dealerships with a workforce of eight. It listed flat and now trades 51 per

cent below its issue price.

MOVERS AND SHAKERS

The sectoral break-up paints a similar picture. Among sectors with meaningful representation, “Trading” has been one of the weakest performers, with 42 of 74 stocks (57 per cent) ruling below their issue price and 25 companies losing more than half their value. ‘IT-Software’ presents a mixed bag. While 42 of the 76 companies trade below their issue price, the sector has also produced 17 stocks that have more than doubled. ‘Textiles’, with 51 listings, also disappointed in-

FSSAI sends 9 notices to Swiggy Instamart over complaints of spoiled food items supply

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) on Saturday said it has issued nine notices to quick commerce platform Swiggy Instamart following multiple consumer complaints alleging violations of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.

The complaints alleged the supply of expired, spoiled, rotten, contaminated and unsafe food products. The notices have also raised concerns over seller onboarding, compliance verification, traceability, food quality monitoring, consumer grievance redress, supervision of food business activities and the adequacy of food safety complaint systems.

EXPLANATION SOUGHT
FSSAI has asked Swiggy In-

stamart to submit a detailed explanation and compliance report, failing which appropriate legal action may be initiated.

When contacted, an Instamart spokesperson said, “We are reviewing the flagged listings by FSSAI and are in touch with the authorities to resolve the same.”

Outlining the alleged violations in a social media post, FSSAI said NOICE eggs were marketed under a brand name not covered under the product categories approved in the existing FSSAI licence. “The food business operator was directed not to market the product unless it was covered under the valid licence and to apply for licence modification, if required,” it added.

The regulator also cited complaints alleging that “Healthify 100 per cent Whey Protein 1 Kg” and “Noice

Homestyle Madras Minute with Peanuts” were supplied after their expiry date. In another case, Akshayakalpa Organic Eggs were allegedly delivered in an expired, rotten condition with a foul odour and signs of contamination, rendering them unfit for consumption. Similarly, “Kakke da Parantha” was reportedly found spoiled and emitting an odour. FSSAI alleged that no corrective action was taken despite escalation of these complaints.

“An infant food formulation was reportedly found in a highly deteriorated and unsafe condition, showing signs of contamination and improper storage and handling. The same product was allegedly re-supplied after the defective product had been returned,” the FSSAI's post stated.

In a regulatory filing, the Bengaluru-based company

said it had received a prohibition order dated July 6 from the FSSAI's designated officer in Karnataka over certain observations related to its FSSAI licence for Toing. The company clarified that the matter was administrative.

These are routine inspections and such observations can happen during checks at dark stores and restaurants. The bigger issue is ensuring processes are robust enough to identify and remove products before they become a problem,” said Satish Meena, founder of Datum Intelligence.

Swiggy reported a reduced net loss of ₹800 crore in Q4FY26 down from ₹1,081 crore a year ago, while revenue rose 45 per cent on year to ₹6,383 crore.

With additional inputs from
Jyoti Banthia, Bengaluru

India, New Zealand to speed implementation of FTA; to double trade to ₹35,000 cr by 2030

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

India and New Zealand have committed to ensuring the early entry into force and effective implementation of the Free Trade Agreement (FTA), as outlined in a vision document unveiled in Auckland on Saturday. The two countries also elevated their ties to a strategic partnership, setting a 2030 roadmap to double bilateral trade in goods and services to ₹35,000 crore (NZ\$7 billion) over the next four years.

The strategic partnership envisages deeper cooperation in trade, defence, maritime security, tourism, culture, sports, agri-tech, people-to-people exchanges, and coordination on Indo-Pacific priorities and multi-lateral issues. Prime Minister Narendra



Modi and his New Zealand counterpart Christopher Luxon announced the roadmap after bilateral talks in Auckland. The FTA was signed on April 27, 2026.

RATIFICATION ON

The announcement is expected to ease concerns over opposition to the pact from sections of New Zealand's ruling coalition and its dairy industry. While the ratification process has begun in New Zealand, with the first of the three mandatory par-

liamentary readings completed, no timeline has been set for the agreement to come into force.

External Affairs Secretary (East) Rudrendra Tandon said New Zealand had assured India that the agreement enjoys bipartisan political backing and that the ratification process would move ahead swiftly.

Despite differences within the ruling coalition, he said Prime Minister Luxon had conveyed that the FTA enjoys broad political support.

On the implementation timeline, he added: “There is no commitment to a set date, but the ratification process has begun... There is hope that these readings will proceed quickly and the process will be completed sooner rather than later.”

Modi and Luxon also interacted with a select group

of CEOs and business leaders, urging them to expand investments and commercial partnerships to help achieve the bilateral trade target by 2030.

INVESTMENT PUSH

Describing the FTA as a landmark agreement, Modi said it would deepen economic ties and create new opportunities in market access, investment, services, technology and talent mobility.

On New Zealand's announcement to facilitate up to \$20 billion in investments, Tandon said the focus was on building a long-term economic partnership rather than creating binding investment commitments.

The two sides also signed a Memorandum of Arrangement on Maritime Cooperation between India's Ministry of Defence and the New Zealand Defence Force.

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INVESTMENT. FOCUS

Gland Pharma: Accumulate on dips

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Gland Pharma, a generic injectables manufacturer and CDMO, is on a recovery path. The company is well placed to sustain its growth momentum, driven by three key CDMO contracts, GPO purchase agreements, new product launches and capacity expansion.

A key growth catalyst is the ramp-up in its GLP-1 fill-finish capacity to 140 million units annually from 40 million.

While the April 2023 acquisition of France-based CDMO Cenexi weighed on EBITDA margins despite higher revenues, profitability recovered over the last two quarters of FY26 and is expected to improve further. The stock trades at 31x one-year forward earnings, above its five-year average of 28x.

We recommend accumulating the stock on corrections to build in a margin of safety.

Details p5

Nishanth Gopalakrishnan
bl. research bureau

Artificial intelligence (AI) has arrived and how! It has taken centre stage as the next-gen general purpose technology and is rapidly changing the world as we know it. It is now a force upending markets, business models, capital allocation decisions and even the way we need to plan for our future energy needs. Companies are racing to fold AI into their operations, and some are even learning that adoption without discipline comes with costs.

As this shift plays out, the vocabulary of AI is no longer confined to tech blogs and research papers. It is getting mainstream and quietly infiltrating boardrooms, earnings calls and other market literature. Terms like ‘tokenomics’, ‘agentic AI’ and ‘open-source’ are increasingly becoming how companies describe their spending and strategy.

So, as investors, it is a good time to get started on these terms and this article aims to help you get warmed up on what they mean and why they matter economically. Read on to find out.

TOKENS

As humans, the smallest unit of information we use to represent language is a single character — which could be a letter or a number or a punctuation mark. But the smallest unit of language that a large language model (LLM) uses is called a token. A token can be a set of characters, or a part of a word or a syllable or a whole word or even a short multi-word phrase. The code that converts language to tokens is called a tokeniser (refer illustration).

A good rule of thumb is that an English word is represented by approximately 1.5 tokens. So, if you input a prompt that is 100-word long, the LLM will likely work with 150 tokens. Conversely, one may say a token is about two-thirds to three-fourths of a word. However, this is just to give some perspective. For image-/audio-/video-based inputs, it is not possible to apply this thumb rule. After the input is tokenised, the model then converts the tokens into vectors, which are a long list of numbers. These vectors form the basic computational unit on which the model performs calculations to generate output.

That said, let’s understand tokenomics. When it comes to LLMs, model providers such as OpenAI and Anthropic bill customers by tokens, which directly relate to the amount of processing their GPUs perform for a given prompt. Higher the tokens involved, higher the workload on the GPUs which in turn translate to higher cost for the model provider. This billing by tokens is more true of enterprise customers who use APIs (application programming interface) to connect their enterprise software to an LLM than of consumers like you and me.

Just as electricity bills are based on units consumed, LLM billing is based on tokens consumed. However, electricity bills change based on what kind of consumer you are. Industrial consumers pay more than what residential consumers do. Similarly, pricing of the LLMs depends on the complexity of the model. A larger, more robust model will cost more per token and vice-versa. Typically, users are billed per million tokens and further, there is a difference based on whether the token is part of the input or part of the output. Input tokens cost lower than output tokens because the amount of processing required to generate a text output, for instance, is higher than reading a text input.

Over the past year or so, companies have pushed their workforce to adopt AI in their workflows, often without capping token consumption. Employees were even tracked and ranked based on token usage, as a proxy to measure productivity and to evaluate whether they have become ‘AI-native’. This led to a phenomenon known as ‘token-maxxing’. This often incentivised employees to use larger/ reasoning models to boost token consumption even when the problem didn’t warrant their use. Do note that the reasoning steps also consume tokens even though they don’t show up in the output as such.

An unnamed enterprise cus-

Welcome to the world of AI-nomics

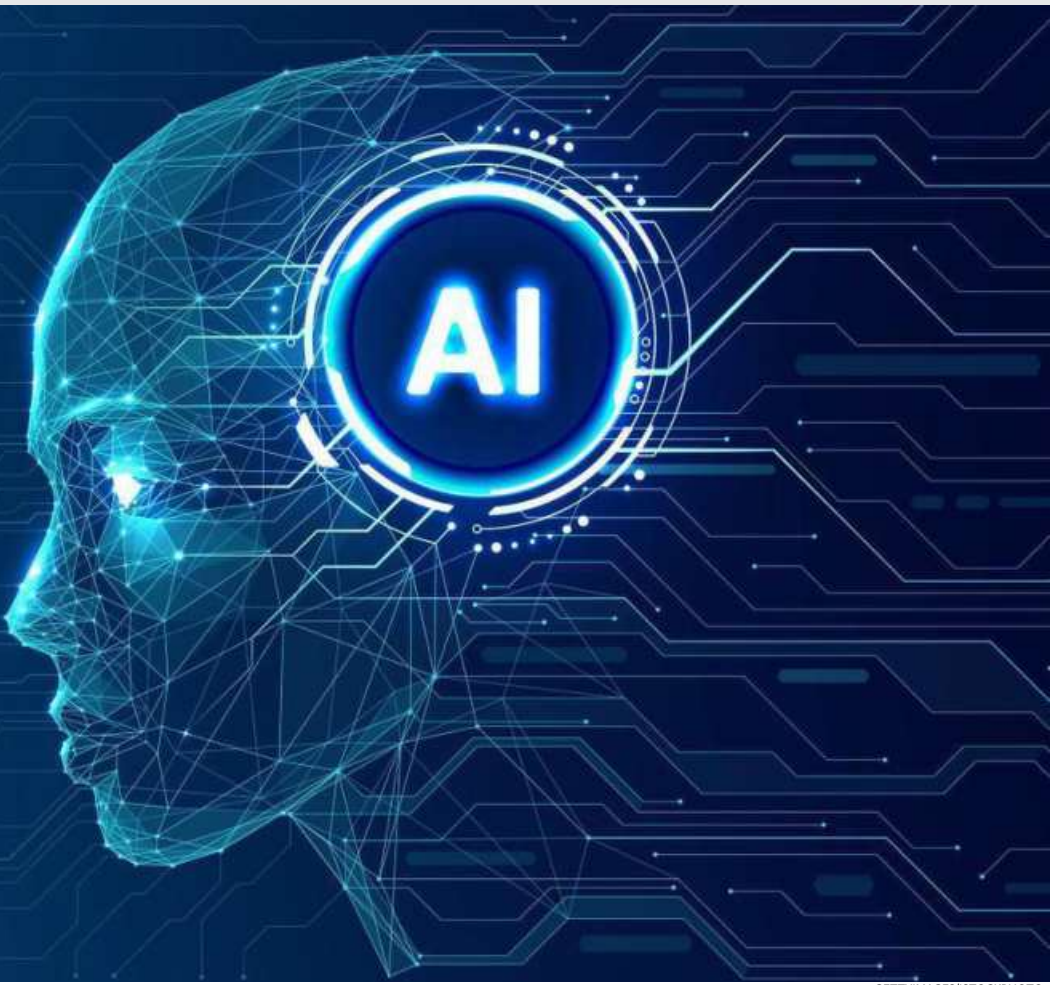
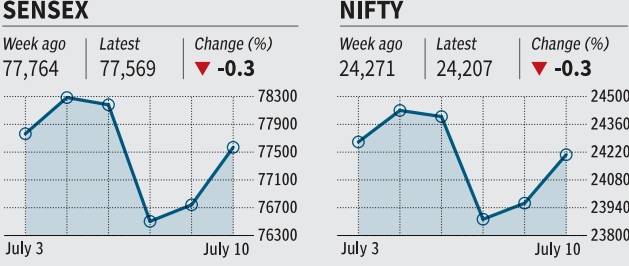
ARTIFICIAL IS REAL. Are you familiar with tokenomics, agentic AI and open-source? Read on to know what these terms mean and how they matter economically to investors

WISE WORDS.

“The distinction between investment and speculation in common stocks has always been a useful one and its disappearance is a cause for concern

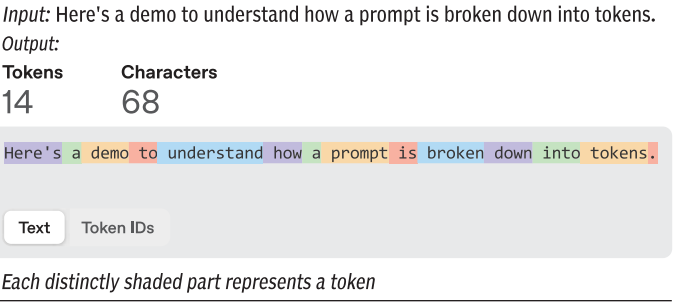
BENJAMIN GRAHAM
‘Father of value investing’

MARKET ACTION.



GETTYIMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

How a tokeniser works



tomor of Anthropic was reported to have burned \$500-million worth of tokens just because it failed to set spending cap per employee. Similarly, Uber reportedly spent its entire 2026 AI budget in just four months. Its COO even commented that they haven’t yet been able to draw a connection between the company’s use of Claude Code and the amount of consumer features it is shipping. This has led the company to set a cap of \$1,500 per employee per month per AI tool in early June. This is becoming an observable trend in other companies too. Ford is reported to have rehired over 300 veteran quality inspectors after investments in AI failed to live up to expectations.

While this retreat may turn out to be a short-term fallout of ‘tokenmaxxing’, cost per token appears to have dropped significantly over the last three years — by over 90 per cent, going by some estimates. It remains to be seen whether a balanced approach (after spend caps) towards AI spends results in a favourable cost-benefit equation for enterprises, going forward.

AGENTIC AI

Agentic AI is one of the most powerful applications of LLMs. It refers to the ability of an AI model to spawn and deploy agents meant to carry out a complex task. Here’s how an agent is defined. Agents are **autonomous** systems that can operate independently, use various **tools** to accomplish **complex** tasks, **planned** and executed step after step using the **reasoning** abilities of an LLM.

Here’s an example. Let’s say a user prompts an LLM with agentic abilities ‘Create a to-do list app’. Here the model, without depending on the user (autonom-

ously), internally creates a plan of action, enabled by its ability to reason. The plan could look something like:

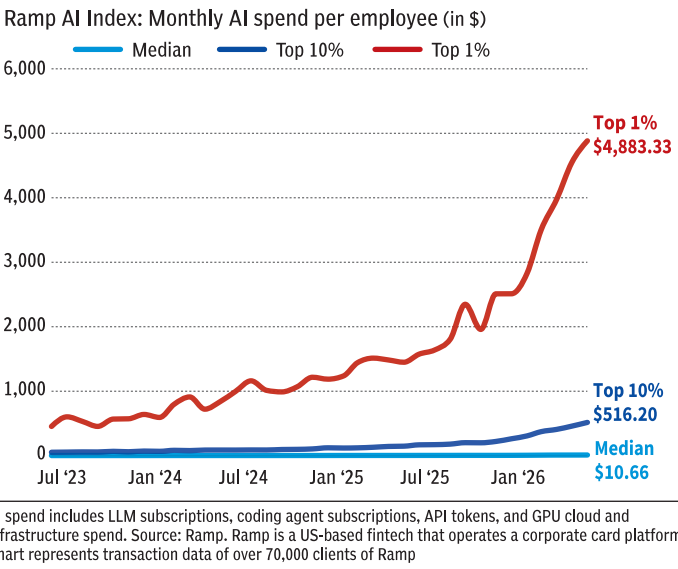
- Define the features of a to-do list app
- Write the code
- Test the code
- Debug the code
- Test and debug the code until the app is stable
- Deploy the app

The model will then execute all milestones on its own, turning to the user only if it needs additional inputs. This is a simple way to understand how a typical coding agent works.

You may wonder that a chatbot, too, can pull this off. But it may need a detailed prompt from the user that basically incorporates the above milestones and guides the model what to do in a sequence. It may not independently carry out the task in the absence of such a prompt. Autonomy, ability to plan and reason, ability to handle complex tasks – all are defining characteristics of an agent.

Another key feature of an agent is the ability to call the right tool to discharge the task. Let’s say a user prompts a model to find out how much an Indigo flight ticket to Goa costs on a Saturday when he is free in the immediate future. The model has to first know when he is free. It needs access to his calendar app (the tool) to know the same. Next, it will write the code to call his Google Calendar using something called an API. An API is simply a piece of code that lets the model talk to a tool. It then runs a code until it finds out the very next Saturday the user doesn’t have any appointments on. Knowing this information, it then connects to the API of another tool — this time to that of a travel booking website (say, Skyscanner) to

AI cost per employee on the rise



collect the ticket prices of Indigo flights to Goa on that specific Saturday. Once done, returns the findings to the user — all done without much intervention from the user.

While agents are powerful, here’s a key factor one has to remember. When an agent reasons, plans, instructs itself the steps or runs iterations of the code until the task is done — all these consume tokens, even though they don’t show up in the output. Also, when the agent goes through multiple iterations, it will essentially try to keep the earlier iterations also in memory and such iterations become input for the next iteration. Thus, the tokens consumed in earlier iterations keep adding up after each iteration. This makes agentic AI token guzzlers when not managed efficiently.

PROPRIETARY VS OPEN-SOURCE MODELS

A proprietary LLM is developed and owned by the organisation that develops it. The training code, training data and the model’s parameters (which determine its size – whether it is a large or small model; parameters are often used interchangeably with ‘weights’) are private and not available for access by outsiders. Popular LLMs such as OpenAI’s GPT series, Anthropic’s Claude Sonnet, Claude Opus series and Google’s Gemini are examples of proprietary models.

On the other hand, an open-source model is available for commercial use by persons other than the developer. Basically, one doesn’t need a licence from the developer to use the model. DeepSeek-R1, Alibaba’s Qwen3.6, Meta’s Llama 4 and Mistral 3 are popular examples. Readers must observe a nuance here. In the traditional sense, ‘open-source’ would mean that the source code is accessible. However, in the AI world, open open-source models are simply open-weight models — meaning only the model weights are open-source while the training data and training code remain private. This is true of the models mentioned above. Essentially, the difference between a proprietary model and an open-source one boils down to whether the weights are open-source.

What are weights then? Since it could get too technical, here’s

what you need to know. Weights (or parameters) determine which piece of input information a model must pay attention to. These are set by the developer during the training phase. Higher the number of weights, larger the model. For context, DeepSeek-R1 reportedly uses 671 billion parameters.

Say, a user gives a prompt that reads ‘Einstein proposed the theory of’, a good LLM will predict the next token as ‘relativity’ and deliver the output. This happens because once the LLM sees the tokens ‘Einstein’ and ‘theory’, it will also see the highest weight assigned to the token ‘relativity’. If the model hadn’t been properly trained and a random token, say, ‘gravity’ is seen to be carrying higher weight by the model than for ‘relativity’, it will then hallucinate and deliver ‘gravity’ instead of the accurate ‘relativity’.

In an open-weight model, the user can ‘fine-tune’ the weights according to his preferences and build a new product or app with such model. Models such as DeepSeek-R1 let users to even train a new model altogether (typically a smaller model) based on the original model. The model so derived is called a distilled model. For a text-to-speech application strictly for Indian languages, for instance, a user can prune some weights off the larger model (based on which contribute least, thus shrinking its size) and then fine-tune (train) the weights left behind entirely on Indian languages.

Reduction in the number of parameters leads to reduction in the model’s size, eventually resulting in the need for lower compute relative to running the original model as such. This particularly makes sense for specialised applications such as drug discovery, flight scheduling for pilots, etc., where the model is not expected to serve other use-cases.

Broad differences between using an open-source model as against a proprietary model are captured in the table.

SCALING LAWS

As far as LLMs are concerned, research has shown that there is a predicted rise in a model’s performance (accuracy of the prediction) when the following three are scaled up – model’s size (parameters), training data and compute.

However, there exists a delicate balance among the three, and over scaling of any one of them will not yield a meaningful improvement in performance. Think of this like a chemical equation. Assume the equation states you need one portion of molecule A, two portions of molecule B and three portions of molecule C to get one portion of compound D. If you want to scale the output to two portions of compound D, you will need twice the amount of all three input molecules — that is, two portions of A, four portions of B and six portions of C. More or less of any one of the three input molecules will not result in compound D, which is the desired result.

In its research paper known as the Chinchilla paper, DeepMind researchers found that for compute-optimal training, the model size and the training data should be scaled equally: For every doubling of model size, the number of training tokens should also be doubled. They found that a smaller Chinchilla model with only 70 billion parameters trained on the same amount of compute as some larger models (like Gopher (280 billion parameters) and GPT-3 (175 billion parameters)), outperformed the larger models because it was trained on over four times the training data as the larger models. This means that the larger models had over-scaled on model size before scaling the training data.

That said, can the three factors that impact a model’s performance be scaled indefinitely? No, as there will likely be bottlenecks. In the past, there have been bottlenecks. In the 2000s, compute was a bottleneck until researchers recognised GPUs could train models instead of CPUs. In a recent case, limitation to scale models was overcome by the transformer architecture – an innovation in model architecture itself. It was first put forward in 2017 in a seminal research paper by Google researchers called ‘Attention is All You Need’, which now underpins modern LLMs such as Claude, GPT series and Gemini. The architecture basically allows all tokens in a sequence to be processed simultaneously, which earlier architectures couldn’t.

Today, AI labs like OpenAI and Anthropic, and hyperscalers such as Amazon, Microsoft and Google

are investing over a trillion dollars to scale the compute factor. However, training data could be a possible bottleneck, going forward. Assuming today’s models have trained on all digitally-available data and assuming that incremental data could be contaminated by gen-AI content (gen-AI usage is more prevalent in content created today than before 2022 when ChatGPT was rolled out), scaling quality training data could soon hit a bottleneck. If that materialises, there is a chance that incremental compute being invested on now may not meaningfully yield the desired performance uptick.

ARTIFICIAL GENERAL INTELLIGENCE

AGI or artificial general intelligence is another phrase that readers could stumble upon quite often and all major AI labs of today invariably have reaching AGI as their goal. AGI is when an AI system can match or surpass the cognitive abilities of humans. When that happens, AGI can **autonomously** learn, reason and transfer knowledge seamlessly from one unfamiliar task to another without human intervention. AGI is also referred to as ‘strong AI’.

On the other hand, we have ‘weak AI’ or artificial narrow intelligence (ANI). These are systems that are designed to excel at a single, predefined task. A chess bot or a facial recognition software in a security device or a piece of code that automatically classifies an e-mail as spam are good examples. They cannot write essays or generate images or process medical scans.

Where do today’s LLMs fall? They are still technically ANI but occupy a middle ground that challenges the traditional definition of ANI. LLMs, today, are versatile. They can do math, generate multimodal content, translate and so on. However, companies like IBM still regard them as narrow intelligence and hold that today, AGI is nothing more than a theoretical concept. According to critics of the technology, LLMs may be good at predicting the next most statistically probable word but are far from autonomously achieving the level of spatial reasoning, fine motor coordination, social-emotional awareness and so on that human beings are capable of.

How open-source and proprietary models compare

Criterion	Open-source	Proprietary
Upfront R&D cost	High. Since one may have to hire AI engineers to ‘fine-tune’ weights or train a distilled model	Zero, plug and play. Weights are determined by the developer. R&D cost is recovered through subscription revenue or token-based billing
Running cost	Leasing cost of a cloud server — typically based on server uptime	Often billed based on token consumption
Data privacy	Data stays on your servers	Data leaves your system
Maintenance	Entails the need for a maintenance team to constantly fix bugs, tweak weights	Maintenance including security patches handled by the developer
When to consider	When there is predictably high traffic	When there is low traffic or occasionally high traffic

Aarati Krishnan

Since the Iran conflict broke out, established conventions in investing have flown out of the window. Asset allocation has been one casualty.

Divide your portfolio between different uncorrelated assets, experts always said, and you will enjoy a smoother journey with better returns. But Indian investors who maintained asset-allocated portfolios have suffered higher value erosion than folks who didn't, since early this year.

From February 28 (when the Iran war broke out) till date, stock markets have declined about 5 per cent (at the Nifty50 level) on fears that rising energy prices will dent company earnings. Bonds usually move in the opposite direction to stocks. But on this occasion, bond prices too fell, on fears that rising commodity prices will revive inflation and interest rate hikes.

Gold, which usually rockets during crises, let down investors too. Since February-end, gold has fallen 11 per cent in rupee terms. The prospect of rate hikes in the US has made global investors prefer US treasuries over gold, as a safe-haven choice.

If all asset classes are going to tumble in tandem when a crisis breaks out, what's the point in my maintaining an asset-allocated portfolio?

You may also be wondering if asset allocation works in the real world.

This is why we ran the numbers on how an asset allocated portfolio would have fared in the last 11 years, using actual returns on different assets.

We found that an asset allocated portfolio with 60 per cent equity, 30 per cent debt and 10 per cent gold, delivered almost the same returns as an equity-only portfolio, with a much smoother journey.

METHODOLOGY

We assumed that an investor started out with ₹1 lakh to invest in end-2014. He invested ₹60,000 in a Nifty50 index fund, ₹30,000 in a

Does asset allocation really work?

REAL RETURNS. Yes, it does, proves a live testing of a 60-30-10 portfolio over the last 11 years

MIX N MATCH

- Diversification softened losses in difficult years
- Rebalancing converts market excess into discipline
- Returns matched equity with smoother ride

short-term debt fund (we took the category average as proxy) and ₹10,000 in a gold exchange traded fund (category average).

We then traced the growth of this portfolio based on actual returns delivered by each of these assets in every calendar year.

At the end of each calendar year, we took stock of the portfolio's asset allocation after accounting for gains.

If any asset overshoot its preferred allocation by 5 percentage points or more, we booked profits on it and moved the excess to the other two assets. The asset with the higher shortfall compared to the preferred allocation was re-filled first.

This exercise did not lead to much portfolio churn. In the 11-year period, there were only two years where the portfolio needed rebalancing.

By the end of 2021, the equity portion climbed to 65.6 per cent and had to be rebalanced back to 60 per cent. The profits booked on equity were reinvested in debt, which had fallen to a 25 per cent allocation.

In 2025, the gold allocation shot up to 15 per cent of the portfolio, requiring profit-booking on

gold and reinvesting that sum back into debt and equity. The behaviour of this rebalanced portfolio is captured in the accompanying table.

TAKEAWAYS

We compared how the asset-allocated portfolio fared over the 11 years, against a full-equity portfolio invested only in the Nifty50.

These were the findings:

- Both the equity-only portfolio and asset-allocated portfolio delivered positive returns in nine of the 11 years.
- Both had two negative years – 2015 and 2026. However, the asset-allocated portfolio suffered much lower losses than the equity-only portfolio. This is



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Asset allocated portfolio: A smoother journey for similar returns

Calendar year	Return %			Allocation %			Portfolio value (₹)	Portfolio return (%)
	Nifty50	Debt fund	Gold ETF	Equity	Debt	Gold		
2015	-4.1	8.4	-8.3	58	33	9	99,230	-0.8
2016	3.01	9.8	11.8	56	34	10	1,05,231	6.0
2017	28.6	6.1	2.3	61	30	8	1,24,597	18.4
2018	3.2	6.8	7.2	60	31	9	1,30,367	4.6
2019	12	5.1	22.8	61	29	10	1,44,434	10.8
2020	14.9	9.6	26.9	61	28	11	1,65,357	14.5
2021	24.1	5.3	-4.8	60	31	9	1,91,383	15.7
2022	4.3	4.8	12.8	59	31	9	2,01,329	5.2
2023	19.4	7.3	14.1	62	29	9	2,31,798	15.1
2024	8.8	8.3	19	61	29	10	2,73,819	18.1
2025	10.5	8	75.8	60	30	10	2,95,582	7.9
YTD 2026	-8.1	3	5.8	57	32	11	2,85,592	-3.4

*Debt fund and Gold ETF refers to category average returns of short-term debt funds and gold ETFs. Portfolio assumes starting with a 60-30-10 allocation on ₹1 lakh. Rebalancing to the original allocation done when any asset overshoots by 5% pts

good because behaviourally, an investor suffering a 3 per cent loss will face less stress and temptation to pull out during a market fall, than one faced with an 8 per cent loss of net worth.

The best years for the equity-only portfolio saw big gains of 28.6 per cent and 24.1 per cent in 2017 and 2021. The best years for

the asset-allocated portfolio saw more moderate returns of 18.4 per cent and 18.1 per cent in 2017 and 2024.

The performance of equity, debt and gold each year, demonstrates the benefit of diversifying across assets. In 2016, when equities delivered a mere 3 per cent, debt and gold lifted up portfolio re-

turns with a 9.8 and 11.8 per cent gain respectively. In 2017, when debt and gold delivered poor returns at 6.1 per cent and 2.3 per cent respectively, equity saved the day with 28.6 per cent.

In several years where equity delivered single-digit gains or losses (2016, 2022, 2026), gold managed gains and debt anchored

the portfolio with stable returns.

One of the main pluses of maintaining a fixed asset allocation is that it forces rule-based profit-booking on outperforming assets. In our asset-allocated portfolio, an investor would have been forced to book profits on equity at the end of 2021, after three years of double-digit gains.

He would have also been nudged into booking profits on gold at the end of 2025, after a bumper 75.8 per cent gain.

It is doubtful if any investors, left to themselves would have booked profits at those times, when maximum greed was at play.

Overall, the 60-30-10 portfolio delivered an almost identical return to the fully equity portfolio over this 11-year period, at a respectable 10 per cent.

The asset-allocated portfolio, however, subjected investors to a less bumpy journey.

It also managed to deliver a better overall return than the equity-only portfolio in six out of the 11 years.

That's surely a solid testimony for asset allocation.

The author is a Contributing Editor

TAX QUERY

I am writing to seek guidance on a capital gains tax matter arising from a share amalgamation, the details of which are set out below.

Facts of the case:

I had purchased shares of Bharat Finance in two tranches:
• 1,000 shares on December 13, 2013, at a total cost of ₹1,71,761.40
• 500 shares on December 20, 2016, at a total cost of ₹1,10,015.97
Subsequently, pursuant to an amalgamation, the above shares were converted into 958 shares of IndusInd Bank at a conversion ratio of 639 shares of IndusInd Bank per 1,000 shares of Bharat Finance, effective July 4, 2019. On May 12, 2025, I sold the entire holding of 958 shares of IndusInd Bank for a total sale consideration of ₹7,56,272.16.

Queries:

- How should the cost of acquisition and the holding period be determined for the IndusInd Bank shares received pursuant to the amalgamation?
- What is the nature of the capital gain — short-term or long-term — given that the original shares of Bharat Finance were purchased in 2013 and 2016 respectively?
- Whether the grandfathering provisions under Section 112A of the Income-Tax Act, 1961 (Fair Market Value as on January 31, 2018) would be applicable, and if so, how should the FMV be computed for shares received in an amalgamation?
- Whether the amalgamation qualifies as a tax-neutral transfer under Section 47(vii) of the Income-Tax Act, 1961, and what conditions must be satisfied for the same?
- What would be the final tax liability, if any, on the said transaction, and how should it be reported in the income tax return?

Nikhil Kumar

Cost of acquisition and period of holding of IndusInd Bank shares: Under the provisions of the Income Tax Act the pertinent sections are Section 47(vii), read with section Section 49(2) to be read along with Explanation 1 (i) (c) to Section 2(42A) of the Income Tax Act, 1961 provides the basis for arriving at the cost of acquisition in such cases -

Under the approved swap ratio of 639 shares of IndusInd Bank for every 1,000 shares of Bharat Financial Inclusion or BFIL (formerly Bharat Finance), the allocation would be as in the first table.

Nature of capital gain: For determining whether the gain is short-term or long-term, the holding period of BFIL shares is included and since the original shares were acquired on December 13, 2013, and December 20, 2016, respectively, both holdings exceed 12 months.

Accordingly, the gain arising on sale of all 958 shares on May 12, 2025, is Long-Term



Original lot	BFIL shares	Conversion ratio	IndusInd shares received	Original cost (₹)
Lot 1	1,000	639/1000	639	1,71,761.40
Lot 2	500	639/1000	319*	1,10,015.97

(*rounded as per the actual allotment methodology adopted under the scheme)

Accordingly:

Cost of 639 shares = **₹1,71,761.40** | Cost of 319 shares = **₹1,10,015.97**

Total cost of acquisition of the 958 IndusInd Bank shares = **₹2,81,777.37**

Final capital gains computation

Particulars	Amount (₹)
Sale consideration received	7,56,272.16
Less: Grandfathered cost of acquisition **	7,56,272.16
Long-term capital gain under section 112A	NIL

**The grandfathered cost gets restricted to the actual sale consideration attributable to the shares. Consequently, the taxable long-term capital gain becomes Nil. The computation of cost is to be done as below

Ref	Particulars	First Lot	Second lot	Total
	Number of shares - Bharat Finance	1,000	500	1,500
	Date of purchase	Dec 12, 2013	Dec 20, 2016	-
(i)	Actual cost per share	171.76	220.03	-
(ii)	FMV as on 31.01.2018 (as per BSE Bhav copy)	1,056.45	1,056.45	-
(iii)	Sale value attributable	504.64	504.64	-
(iv)	Lower of FMV and sale value viz between (ii) and (iii)	504.64	504.64	-
(v)	Higher of actual cost and above viz (i) and (iv)	504.64	504.64	-
	Cost as per grand fathering technique	5,04,640	2,52,320	7,56,960

Capital Gain (LTCG).

Applicability of grandfathering under Section 112A: The grandfathering provisions introduced by the Finance Act, 2018 apply because:

- The original shares of Bharat Finance

were acquired before January 31, 2018.

The shares sold are equity shares on which Securities Transaction Tax (STT) requirements are satisfied.

The CBDT has clarified that, in cases of amalgamation, the Fair Market Value



DESIKAN GOVINDARAJAN

(FMV) as on January 31, 2018, of the original shares of the amalgamating company shall be considered for grandfathering purposes.

Therefore, for each lot, the deemed cost under Section 55(2)(ac) will be:

Higher of:

- Actual cost of acquisition, and
- Lower of:

- o FMV as on January 31, 2018, of BFIL shares, and
- o Sale consideration attributable to such shares.

Whether the amalgamation is tax neutral under Section 47(vii): The exchange of BFIL shares for IndusInd Bank shares qualifies as a transfer not regarded as transfer under Section 47(vii), provided:

- There is a valid scheme of amalgamation;
- The shareholder receives only shares of the amalgamated company in consideration (except permitted fractional cash adjustments);
- The amalgamated company is an Indian company;

In the present case:

- Bharat Financial Inclusion amalgamated with IndusInd Bank;
- IndusInd Bank is an Indian company;
- Consideration was received in the form of shares (assumed in the absence of information provided);

Hence, the exchange of shares pursuant to the amalgamation is tax-neutral and no capital gains will arise on this transaction.

The writer is a practising Chartered Accountant and a Partner at Venkatesh and Co.

• Send your queries to taxtalk@thehindu.co.in

ALERTS.

PhonePe launches All-in-One Tax Filing Solution on its platform

PhonePe has announced the launch of a comprehensive 'Tax Filing' feature on its platform. Built to simplify tax compliance for individuals, freelancers and small businesses alike, this feature allows millions of PhonePe users to seamlessly file their income-tax returns (ITR) and manage monthly GST compliances directly within the app's trusted ecosystem. Launched in partnership with TaxBuddy, one of India's leading digital tax compliance platforms, this feature offers an integrated suite of services. This includes independent self-filing starting at ₹24, expert-assisted plans for complex tax scenarios and monthly GST filing for small merchants. This native experience eliminates the need to visit external portals by providing end-to-end compliance tools, such as dedicated expert support for ITR optimisation and seamless ongoing GST filing.



MAHARASHTRA METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A joint venture of Govt. of India & Govt. of Maharashtra)
(Pune Metro Rail Project- Phase 2)
Metro Bhawan, Above District Court Metro Station, Nyaymurti
Ranade Path, Shivajinagar, Pune 411005
Website: www.punemetrorail.org E-mail id: tenders.pmrp@mahametro.org
e-tender portal <https://mahatenders.gov.in> Telephone: 020-26051074

E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender Notice No: P1-O&M-21/2026 Dated: 10-July-2026
Name of Work: Outsourcing of PMRP Track Maintenance Services of Operational assets of Ballastless, Ballasted Track of Mainline & 2 No's Depots for a period of Two Years and Extendable to One Year.
Tender available from 16:00 Hrs. On 13/07/2026 to 16:00 Hrs. on 29/07/2026.
For all above Tenders Interested bidders may visit Pune Metro Rail website www.punemetrorail.org or Download the Tender documents and obtain further details regarding the Tender from e-tender portal of Govt. of Maharashtra <https://mahatenders.gov.in>.
Additional General Manager (P & C), Maharashtra Metro Rail Corporation
Maha Metro, Greenest Metro

The KCP Limited
CIN : L65991TN1941PLC001128
Registered Office: 'Ramakrishna Buildings'
2, Dr. P.V. Cherian Crescent, Egmore, Chennai 600 008, India
Phone: 044-66772600, Fax: 044-66772620, E-Mail : investor@kcp.co.in, www.kcp.co.in

NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that, In compliance with the provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013, read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015, as amended, the company is pleased to provide e-voting facility to its Members enabling them to cast their vote electronically for all the resolutions as set in the Notice for 85th Annual general Meeting (the Notice) dated 28th May 2026. The Company has availed the e-voting services as provided by National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL).
The Board of Directors have appointed Sri. Balu Sridhar, (FCS : 5869 and CP No.3550) or failing him, Sri Anil Kumar Jain, (FCS: 4851 and CP No. 3283) Partners, M/s. AK Jain & Associates, Company Secretaries, Chennai, as a Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting process and e-voting at the AGM in a fair and transparent manner. The e-voting period commences on Friday, the 31st July 2026 at 9.00 a.m. (IST) and ends on Sunday, the 2nd August 2026 at 5.00 p.m. (IST). The e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL, for voting thereafter.
The voting rights of Members shall be as per the number of equity shares held by them as on the record date / cut off date which is **Monday, the 27th July 2026**. The Notice has been sent to all the Members, whose names appeared in the Register of Member / Record of Depositories as on 3rd July 2026.
Electronic copies of the Notice of 85th AGM and Annual Report for the financial year 2025-2026 have been sent to all the members whose email IDs are registered with the Company/Depository Participants. The same is also available on the Company's website www.kcp.co.in. Physical copies of Notice of the AGM and Annual Report for the financial year 2025-2026 will be sent to those members, who have requested for the same, at their registered address in the permitted mode. The dispatch of said Notice of AGM and 85th Annual Report has been completed on Friday, the 10th July 2026.
Members who have not received Notice and the Annual Report may download the same from the website of the Company through the link. <http://kcp.co.in/agm-reports.html> or download the Notice from the website of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL), i.e. <http://www.evoting.nsdl.com>.
The Members are requested to read the instructions pertaining to e-voting as provided in the Notice carefully. Any query /concern /grievances connected with voting by electronic means may be addressed to the Company by writing to The Company Secretary, The KCP Limited, "Ramakrishna Buildings" 2, Dr. P.V. Cherian Crescent, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 Tel. : (044) 66772622, email : viijays@kcp.co.in.
For THE KCP LIMITED (V. KAVITHA DUTT) Joint Managing Director
Place : Chennai.
Date : 10.07.2026

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Conservative hybrid funds are designed for investors who want to participate in the growth potential of equities without taking on the full volatility associated with equity investing. These schemes predominantly invest 75-90 per cent of their portfolio in debt instruments while maintaining a modest equity allocation of 10-25 per cent, creating a balanced risk-return profile.

With debt forming the bulk of the portfolio, conservative hybrid funds generally experience smaller fluctuations than pure equity funds, yet they have the potential to generate better long-term returns than traditional fixed-income products. This makes them suitable for investors looking for a smoother investment journey.

The category is particularly relevant for risk-conscious investors, with investment horizon of around three to five years, who seek capital appreciation but are uncomfortable with sharp market corrections.

Kotak Debt Hybrid Fund is one of the better-performing schemes in the category over the long term. Over the last 10 years, the fund has delivered a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 8.8 per cent compared with the category average of 7.4 per cent.

EQUITY

The equity component of the fund follows a flexi-cap strategy, generally maintaining an equity allocation of 20-24 per cent.

Stock selection combines both top-down and bottom-up research. The fund first identifies broad macro themes such as consumption versus investment, domestic versus export-oriented businesses, and private sector versus public sector companies. Once these themes are identified, it selects sectors that are best positioned to benefit before narrowing down to individual stocks.

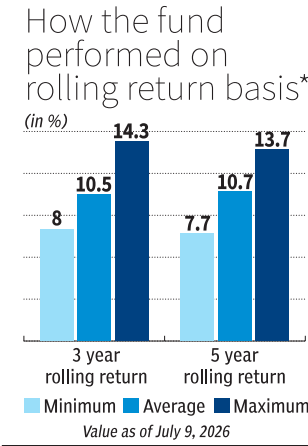
The fund follows its proprietary BMV (business, management and valuation) framework for stock selection. It first identifies businesses growing faster than their industry with scalable and sustainable growth. It then assesses management quality through corporate governance, accounting practices, forensic analysis, cash flows, balance sheet strength and execution. Finally, it evaluates valuations based on return ratios and long-term earnings potential, aiming to buy high-quality growth businesses at reasonable prices rather than chasing expensive growth.

The current equity portfolio has a distinct domestic orientation, focussing on companies

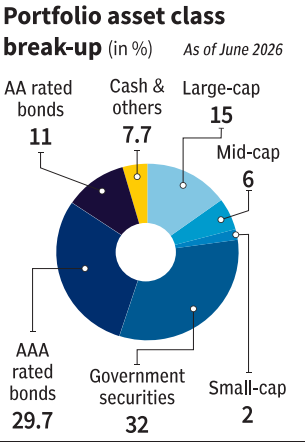


Debt cushion, equity kick

FUND CALL. Kotak Debt Hybrid Fund blends active duration calls with measured domestic equity exposure



The chart illustrates the fund's performance based on 3-year and 5-year rolling returns calculated from the last seven years NAV history, highlighting the minimum, average, and maximum returns achieved over these periods. Source: ACEMF



WHY INVEST

- 10-year CAGR beats category average
- Active duration calls aid performance
- Debt-heavy portfolio limits volatility

that derive the majority of their revenues from India. The fund is overweight private sector banks and healthcare, while maintaining a neutral stance on technology with a preference for digital platform businesses over traditional IT services firms. It also has selective exposure to consumer discretionary stocks, supported by favourable long-term consumption trends.

As per the latest portfolio, the top three sector exposures were banks, automobiles and telecom. Over the last year, the fund increased exposure to banks, healthcare services and fintech companies while trimming exposure to IT, petroleum products and finance.

Around 70-75 per cent of the equity allocation is invested in large-cap companies, with the balance spread across select mid- and small-cap stocks.

DEBT
The fund has been one of the few

in the category to actively manage duration.

It combines long-term strategic positioning with tactical adjustments, emphasising liquidity and yield curve positioning while minimising exposure to credit risk.

Over the last five years, the fund's modified duration has ranged between 1.8 years and 8.8 years, reflecting its active duration strategy.

Currently, the portfolio's modified duration is maintained at around five years. The fund manager believes the RBP's recent policy measures have lowered the risk of aggressive rate hikes over the next couple of months, helping bond yields ease.

Measures to boost capital inflows could support demand for short- to medium-term corporate bonds and, if India is included in the Bloomberg Global Bond Index, long-duration government securities. Accord-

ingly, the fund prefers stable carry through two- to five-year corporate bonds, State Development Loans (SDLs) and 15- to 30-year government securities while avoiding aggressive credit bets.

As per the June 2026 portfolio, the fund had allocated 32 per cent of the overall portfolio to State and Central government securities, 24 per cent to corporate bonds, 9 per cent to money market instruments and 6 per cent to securitised debt.

While geopolitical risks, crude oil prices and uncertainty over Bloomberg bond index inclusion may continue to keep volatility elevated, the fund remains cautious on credit.

About 11 per cent of the overall portfolio is invested in AA-rated securities, with prominent

issuers including Andhra Pradesh Beverages Corporation, Telangana State Industrial Infrastructure Corporation, Adani Power, JTPM Metal Traders and 360 One Prime.

The debt portfolio's yield-to-maturity (YTM) stood at 7.5 per cent compared with the category average of 7.4 per cent.

PERFORMANCE

Kotak Debt Hybrid Fund has exhibited above-average returns across most equity and interest rate cycles.

An analysis of five-year rolling returns over the last seven years shows that the fund generated an average annualised return of 10.7 per cent, outperforming the category average of 8.8 per cent. Its five-year rolling returns ranged from a minimum of 7.7 per cent to a maximum of 13.7 per cent.

On a three-year rolling basis, the fund delivered an average CAGR of 10.5 per cent compared with the category average of 8.9 per cent.

The fund's expense ratio for the regular plan is 1.45 per cent, marginally below the category average of 1.47 per cent. The direct plan's expense ratio stands at 0.49 per cent compared with the category average of 0.74 per cent.

The fund aims to generate returns superior to traditional debt investments while limiting downside risk through a predominantly debt-oriented portfolio.

It may be suitable for investors with a low-to-moderate risk appetite seeking modest equity exposure over a medium-term investment horizon.

ALERTS.

Kotak Mutual Fund launches Kotak Nifty Private Bank ETF

Kotak Mahindra Asset Management Company has announced the launch of the Kotak Nifty Private Bank ETF, an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the Nifty



Private Bank Index. The scheme closed for public subscription on July 15. The Nifty Private Bank index tracks the performance of the leading 10 private sector banks, which are selected from Nifty 500 universe based on their free-float market capitalisation. The index provides exposure to India's

ICICI Prudential MF launches ICICI Prudential Multi-Asset Active FOF

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund announced the launch of the ICICI Prudential Multi-Asset Active FOF, an open-ended fund of funds (FoF) scheme investing predominantly in



units of active equity-oriented schemes, debt-oriented schemes and Gold ETFs/Silver ETFs. The scheme shall adjust exposure across these asset classes based on prevailing market conditions, valuation signals and macroeconomic trends. The NFO closes on July 14. The portfolio allocation framework comprises

30-80 per cent in units of active equity-oriented schemes, 10-60 per cent in units of active debt-oriented schemes and 10-30 per cent in Gold ETFs and/or Silver ETFs.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on Jul 10			
ETF				
Mirae Asset Hang Seng Tech	19.3	23.2	6.8	4,406
Motilal Oswal Nifty Realty	93.7	93.5	5.4	14,159
Groww Nifty Realty ETF	10.5	10.5	5.3	4,092
Mir Asset Nifty Ind Internet	13.6	13.6	4.6	1,233
Groww Nifty India Internet	10.0	10.0	3.9	3,130
Motilal Oswal BSE Select IPO	47.0	47.2	3.0	95
Tata Nifty Digital ETF	84.7	84.0	2.7	433
GOLD ETFs				
LIC MF Gold ETF	128.3	128.9	-1.5	932
Baroda BNP Paribas Gold ETF	137.9	138.5	-1.5	53
Union Gold ETF	139.5	140.1	-1.5	118

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on July 10, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Jul 10	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	54.3	11.5	11.7	13.3	76,649
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	74.8	12.8	12.7	13.2	28,647
Kotak Pension Fund	68.1	12.1	12.4	13.1	4,510
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	31.7	7.5	6.6	8.4	8,797
SBI Pension Fund	42.5	7.5	6.6	7.8	29,192
HDFC Pension Fund	29.0	7.0	6.3	7.7	52,774
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.8	8.2	7.1	8.3	34,250
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	46.3	7.9	6.8	8.0	13,612
SBI Pension Fund	46.6	8.0	6.8	8.0	15,405
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	47.0	11.6	11.7	13.4	1,820
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	59.1	12.5	12.6	13.2	796
Kotak Pension Fund	59.9	12.0	12.4	13.0	219

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on July 10, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	365	11.4	24.7	25.2
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE Bluechip	4	5.7	19.1	16.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	879	1.6	18.4	16.0
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	-1.6	13.3	13.6
MULTI CAP					
New Berry Capitals	Seeking Alpha	9	8.2	20.3	27.3
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	8,102	12.4	36.3	24.6
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	477	9.6	25.4	24.2
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	117	2.9	25.8	23.0
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	-0.1	19.4	21.4
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,148	8.3	21.0	21.4
MID-CAP					
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	32.5	23.3	17.4
Right Horizons	Super Value	NA	5.9	15.4	17.1
Nippon Life India	Emerging India	NA	4.9	17.3	16.0
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-4.7	12.8	15.7
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	2,637	32.0	34.9	33.1
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	972	-2.9	21.7	31.0
Green Portfolio	Super 30 Dynamic Fund	242	15.3	21.4	26.9
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,512	-2.6	27.2	23.2

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on June 30, 2026

Retail traders pick themes over S&P 500

GLOBAL VIEW. This signals the cohort is chasing specific market themes rather than having broad conviction in index

Bloomberg



BLOOMBERG

Retail traders, some of the staunchest supporters of the stock market this decade, are showing signs of waning conviction.

The crowd is hopping in and out of specific stocks at an increasing speed, selling shares almost as aggressively as buying while ignoring the broader S&P 500 Index. The gap between the cash that's come into the stock market and gone out in the past four weeks has shrunk to \$13 billion, the lowest since the Covid-19 pandemic, according to data from Vanda Research.

The development signals that the cohort has become pickier, chasing specific market themes rather than having a broad conviction in benchmark indexes. Chalk it up to the contours of the stock market, where a measure of dispersion is sitting near a record, and gut-wrenching rotations between winners and losers have challenged even institutional pros.

"A selective retail investor is joining what is a very selective institutional investor — one where 2026 has really been a stock picker's world," said Viraj Patel, global macro strategist at the firm.

To Patel, the group's low exposure in US stocks doesn't necessarily spell doom for the asset class as a whole. Rather, it portrays a picture of the casino crowd that's ready to bet on whatever appears to be the next big theme, then scatter as soon as the tide turns.

First it was energy stocks and silver companies that jumped

amid soaring industrial demand and worsening supply shortage. Then came a big moment for software names, before the sector was ditched for semis. Finally, when SpaceX went public in June, retail traders piled into Elon Musk's rocket, satellite and artificial intelligence company and other space-related names.

BULLS VS BEARS

"The 2026 retail investor is very different to anything we've really seen in the post-Covid years," Patel said.

Data from sentiment surveys, which show that risk-on spirits among amateur investors are waning, may partly explain the

FUND FLOW

Retail investors poured \$712 million in technology stocks in the week through July 8, the most among 11 sectors, followed by communications shares, which saw a net inflow of \$617 million

trend. The number of bears in the stock market has outnumbered bulls in all but four weeks since mid-February, according to the American Association of Individual Investors.

For the week ended July 8, 37 per cent of respondents to the firm's sentiment survey said they were bearish on stocks in the next six months, compared with 36 per cent of respondents who were optimistic.

To Bret Kenwell, US investment analyst at Etoro, a potential slowdown in retail appetite reflects both worries around the broader market and technology stocks that are sitting at lofty multiples following this year's advance.

"Chip stocks are consolidating after hefty second-quarter gains, while retail investors may be hesitant to add fresh capital to a sector they view as

For the long haul, fundamentals offer comfort

IPO WATCH. SBI Funds Management, as India’s largest asset manager, offers scale, strong profitability and growth runway, though market cycles and fee pressure remain monitorables

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Incorporated in 1992, SBI Funds Management (SBIFM) is the oldest and the largest asset manager in India in terms of Quarterly Average Assets Under Management (QAAUM) and market share. It is a joint venture between State Bank of India (India's largest bank) and Paris-headquartered Amundi Asset Management (largest European asset manager). The company serves a large unique investor base of 1.8 crore.

The company is the seventh AMC to tap the IPO market. As per SBI's latest July 11 update, promoter shareholders SBI and Amundi plan to raise about ₹9,813 crore by selling up to 17,095 crore shares at the upper end of the ₹545-574 price band. The IPO is entirely an offer for sale, so the company will receive no proceeds. In a pre-IPO placement, SBI has already raised ₹1,655 crore by selling about 2.88 crore shares to 30 investors at ₹574 apiece. The IPO opens on July 14 and closes on July 16. After the issue, the promoters will hold 88.2 per cent, with SBI alone retaining 55.6 per cent. The implied m-cap is about ₹1.17 lakh crore, which should place it after ICICI Pru AMC and HDFC AMC.

At the upper end of the price band, SBI Funds is valued at FY26 P/E multiple of around 38x. This is not expensive and is below like-sized peers such as ICICI Pru AMC (47x), HDFC AMC (39x) and Nippon India (48x) on a trailing twelve-month earnings, per Bloomberg.

Given the still low penetration (India AUM as per cent of GDP is 18.5 per cent vs 126 per cent for US), the mutual fund industry in India expected to grow at a robust pace, helped by rising financialisation of savings. Thus, the runway for growth is long for SBI Funds. As a manufacturer of investments products, it operates a highly scalable, cash-generative business model (we explain later in the article).

Investors can subscribe to the IPO from a five-year or longer perspective. Massive scale, strong position in the AMC business as the leader, healthy operational performance and a seasoned fund management team are positives for the company.

Note that businesses such as AMCs are dependent on market movements. If prolonged bear markets make investors wary with parking surpluses in mutual funds or investors choose to exit during

heavy volatility, there may be challenges and AMC stocks may correct. Since management fees are based on AUM, cyclical declines in markets can impact revenue and profits. Hence, a long-term perspective is required. Any overall reduction of mutual fund management fees by regulator SEBI in the future may also affect earnings.

BUSINESS

SBI Funds Management managed a total of 128 schemes as of March 31, 2026, including one Specialised Investment Fund (SIF) strategy. In the MF side, there were 49 debt schemes, 37 ETFs and index funds, 35 equity and equity-oriented schemes, four domestic Fund of Funds (FoF), two liquid and overnight Schemes etc.

In Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs) space, the company manages SBIFM Special Situations Fund-1, SBI Optimal Equity Fund, SBI Emergent India Fund. In the Portfolio Management Services (PMS), it offers discretionary and non-discretionary management tailored to different client bases. It manages portfolios for global investors who are seeking exposure to Indian equity markets through offshore India-focussed funds and PMS structures.

The company has 1,500+ employees, with 71 in the fund management and investment team. Attrition rate in this bucket is stable at 10-11 per cent for the last three years, and no senior fund manager has left in the last few years.

SBI Funds' offerings are sold to investors through a pan-India distribution network comprising of 1.32 lakh institutional and individual MF distributors. This includes independent financial advisers, national distributors and 95 banks (including SBI), proprietary branch network as well as direct digital channels (InvesTap and website). It maintains presence in 98.2 per cent of India's pincodes.

MODEL

As an asset manager, the core economic engine is management fees. This is calculated as a percentage of the ₹29.46-lakh crore assets (as on March 2026) it manages across offerings. Mutual funds (MFs) - ₹12.5 lakh crore and PMS & Advisory - ₹16.89 lakh crore, mostly derived from EPFO, are the main product lines. AIFs at ₹0.07 lakh crore is minute but has good potential. AIFs command relatively higher yields compared to other traditional asset classes.

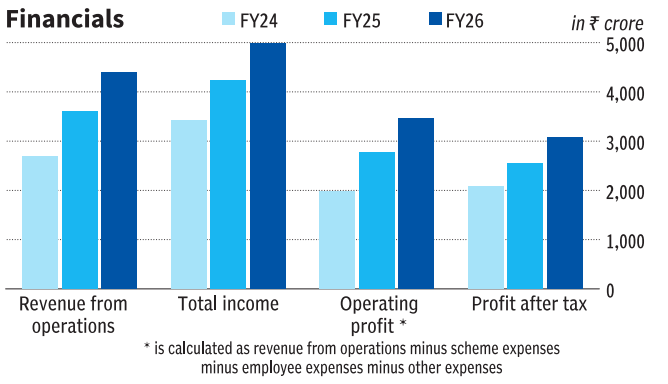
EPFO money operates on compressed fee structures (not great operating revenue yields). Revenue



AMC yield as % of QAAUM

Company	Operating revenue			Operating profit			PAT		
	FY24	FY25	FY26	FY24	FY25	FY26	FY24	FY25	FY26
SBI AMC	0.29	0.34	0.35	0.21	0.25	0.28	0.23	0.24	0.25
ICICI Prudential AMC¹	0.49	0.53	0.52	0.34	0.37	0.38	0.30	0.30	0.30
HDFC AMC	0.42	0.45	0.44	0.31	0.35	0.35	0.32	0.32	0.31
Nippon India AMC	0.38	0.40	0.37	0.22	0.25	0.24	0.26	0.23	0.21
Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC	0.41	0.44	0.42	0.22	0.25	0.24	0.24	0.24	0.22
UTI AMC	0.60	0.54	0.44	0.34	0.31	0.16	0.28	0.24	0.12

QAAUM: Quarterly Average Assets Under Management as on March 2026
1 standalone number: Numbers are rounded off; Information based on the consolidated financials of the AMCs where available; Operating revenue is revenue from operations reported by the companies
Operating profit = Profit before tax - other income Source: CRISIL July 2026 report



from PMS clients and advisory services stood at a mere ₹154 crore or 3.5 per cent of revenue from operations. Instead, it acts as a stable, scale-driven anchor, while retail MFs deliver the actual high-margin yields. Thus, at a company level, FY26 operating revenue yield for SBI Funds was 35 basis points (bps) versus 44 bps for HDFC AMC and 52 bps for ICICI Pru AMC, who are like-sized peers.

Equity, equity-oriented and equity-hybrid schemes (active) account for three-fourth of total management fee income from SBI

MFs. Overall in FY26, their management fees at ₹4,234 crore drove 96.5 per cent of the company's operating revenue (₹4,389 crore).

Revenue yield depends heavily on the asset mix; actively-managed equity funds command higher fee margins than debt or rapidly-growing passive ETFs. At an asset class level, about 43 per cent of MF assets come from active equities and their hybrids, 14 per cent from active debt and their hybrids, 32 per cent from ETFs and index funds and the rest from liquid, overnight, arbitrage, SIFs and FoFs.

IPO rating

SBI Funds Management

Business	★★★★★
Financials	★★★★★
Management	★★★★★
Valuation	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★
Rankings 1 to 5, 1 denoting lowest and 5 highest	
Offer period	July 14- 16, 2026
Price band	₹545-574
Market cap	approx. ₹1.17 lakh cr

IMPACT OF SIPs

SIP inflows provide highly predictable, recurring cash flows. This drastically reduces the AMC's reliance on volatile lump-sum investments, and secures stable management fee income. It holds a market leadership position (11.4 per cent share by inflows) with 1.62-crore live SIP accounts. Nearly 98 per cent have been active for over 37 months, showing high investor stickiness and long-term revenue visibility.

Utilising an asset-light framework, SBI Funds' primary expenses are relatively fixed in the short to medium term. Key costs include employee benefits (9 per cent of total income in FY26). Other expenses includes IT costs, brand royalty, CSR, marketing, etc. In this pie, there is royalty (1.6 per cent of FY26 PAT) paid to parent SBI for brand licencing.

SBI Funds also pays trail commissions to over 1.3 lakh distributors, though these are embedded

within regular plan expense ratios.

Profit is generated by deducting these operational costs from fee revenue. Cost as percentage of assets of SBI Funds at 8bps is the lowest among listed AMCs (10-25 bps). Thus, the business thrives on strong operating leverage. As AUM scales, fee revenue outpaces the fixed cost base. This structural advantage enabled the company to deliver a robust 43 per cent Return on Equity (RoE) and a ₹3,067-crore FY26 net profit. This RoE sits right between HDFC AMC (32.9 per cent) and ICICI Pru AMC (85.8 per cent).

FINANCIALS

Assets under management (AUM) growth is the top-line driver. The company's ₹29.46-lakh crore AUM in FY26 grew at a CAGR of 14.2 per cent between FY24 and FY26. More importantly, the core MF assets grew at a 17 per cent CAGR over the same period. The highest-yielding segment (equity products) outpaced overall growth with an impressive 22 per cent CAGR.

Because of the business's fixed-cost nature, net profit (PAT) grew at a decent 22 per cent CAGR over the FY24-26 period, while total revenue increased at 20.5 per cent CAGR. This operating leverage allowed the PAT margin to expand from 60.50 per cent in FY24 to 61.65 per cent in FY26. In comparison, as per RHP, PAT margins for HDFC AMC (61.8 per cent) and ICICI Pru AMC (55 per cent) were in the same range.

The asset-light model adopted by AMCs is highly cash-generative. In FY26, SBI Funds generated ₹2,487 crore in operating cash flows, which translates to a cash conversion rate of 81.1 per cent. This figure has improved from 69.4 per cent in FY24 and 78.3 per cent in FY25.

The AMC business requires minimal capital expenditure and has no borrowings.

PLANS

Since the IPO is entirely an Offer for Sale (OFS), SBI Funds is not raising fresh capital to fund operations. However, the company has outlined several "growth engines" and strategic initiatives designed to power its next phase of growth.

To accelerate retail customer addition, the company is intensifying its focus on Beyond Top 30 (B-30) cities. This includes deploying dedicated MF specialists in high-potential, underserved geographies, running grassroots investor education campaigns and aggressively expanding the "Jan Nivesh SIP" initiative (low-ticket SIP starting at

₹250) through targeted campaigns to capture first-time MF investors.

The company plans to significantly upgrade its digital engagement and distributor capabilities to increase wallet share and the number of products per customer. They are deploying predictive analytics specifically to identify investors who are at risk of discontinuing their SIPs, allowing for personalised interventions to improve long-term persistency rates.

The rollout of AI-powered chatbots, goal-tracking dashboards and integrated financial planning tools aims to offer targeted product recommendations (such as retirement or education solutions) based on specific investor risk profiles.

Further deepening the integration with SBI's massive YONO digital banking app is on the cards to drive onboarding. It expects universal KYC to potentially double SBIMF's SIP book.

While active MFs are its bread and butter, SBI Funds is expanding its product suite to capture shifting institutional and HNI demand. It aims to broaden the passive portfolio with new thematic, sectoral and "smart beta" equity index funds, alongside fixed-income ETFs (like target maturity and G-Secs) and international/commodity ETFs. It is also expanding aggressively into Category II and Category III AIFs.

Leveraging its dual parentage with Europe's Amundi, the company is building a structural bridge for international capital. They also plan to expand co-managed fund offerings by tapping into Amundi's global distribution network.

RISKS

Apart from market movements and regulatory fee reductions, investors should monitor scheme concentration and fund performance.

While not different from peers, SBI Funds' top 5/10 schemes account for a large chunk of assets. Consequently, underperformance or heavy redemptions from a few large schemes could have a disproportionate impact on revenue and profit.

The growing popularity of passive funds is another risk to revenue yields. Passive products already represent nearly one-third of SBI Funds' MF assets but earn lower fees than actively-managed products.

Operational errors, cyber incidents, regulatory observations or the departure of key fund management personnel could hurt investor confidence and lead to outflows.

Growth gets a booster shot

PHARMACEUTICALS. Gland Pharma's margin improvement and expanding portfolio should support earnings growth

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Gland pharma is primarily a generic injectables manufacturing and CDMO (Contract Development and Manufacturing Outsourcing) company. Its growth will be driven by base operations and recovery in acquired operations. The company has established a strong GLP-1 capacity, which should aid growth in the next three-five years. The stock is trading at 31 times one-year forward earnings compared to the last five-year average of 28 times. The stock has had a volatile past. After a Covid demand driven boom and reaching a peak of ₹4,300 per share in Aug-21, the stock declined to a low of ₹930 per share in June-23 as demand tapered off and significant sales decline in two main products. The company has stabilized operations from there and is on recovery path currently trading at ₹2,475 per share.

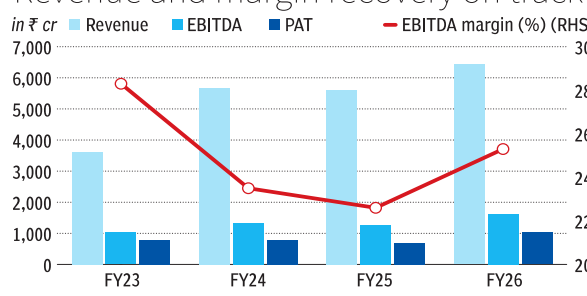
We recommend investors accumulate the stock at opportune corrections to allow for a margin of safety in valuations. The strong outlook for CDMO outsourcing and the established GLP-1 capacity should support the company's earnings growth. But premium valuations leave little room for execution missteps.

US GROWTH DRIVERS

The main growth driver will be new product introduction, which offsets price erosion and adds to growth in the US segment. In FY26, the company launched 31 products. With a base of \$340 million in FY26 from the US, a similar launch schedule in FY27 should sustain growth.

Part of the launches in this fiscal will be generic launches

Revenue and margin recovery on track



under a contract with the US GPOs (group purchase organisations), which collectively purchase generics for the US distribution.

Of the 10-plus contracted generics, three have been launched in late FY26; and along with the remaining launches, these should aid growth in FY27.

Among the FY27 launches are the Dalbavancin (antibiotic) and multivitamin portfolios (launched in early FY27). The high-value products are expected to add 6-8 per cent to the base business.

In the next one-two years, the company will also add three CDMO projects to its base. Three dedicated production lines are under development and expected to be commercialised from FY28, with one of them expected to add 5-6 per cent to the current US sales.

Gland Pharma has developed capacity to be part of the upcoming GLP-1 market. GLP-1 is a leading class of medicine for diabetes that will lose patent protection from FY26 (India, Canada) to FY30 (the US). The company has increased its GLP-1 fill-finish capacity from 40 million per year to 140 million per year. Fill finish is a crucial final step after API manufacturing, where the sterile dose is transferred to vials, ampoules or cartridges through a highly-

sterile and complex system. The company expects to grow into the capacity gradually from FY27, as the GLP-1 market undergoes stages of generic manufacturer approvals, market formation and expansion across markets. In the initial stage, it has signed eight contracts (largely generic manufacturers) and six-seven more are expected. The company will use the facility for other insulin, peptide from other manufacturers as well till capacity is fully achieved.

CENEXI RECOVERY

Gland Pharma acquired France-based CDMO manufacturer - Cenexi in April 2023. The acquisition was at an enterprise value of €230 million, with the firm reporting revenues/EBITDA of €184/23 million in FY21.

Diversification, European foray and technology expansion were the primary reasons for the acquisition. Gland Pharma derived 66 per cent of revenues from the US in FY23 compared with 53 per cent in FY26 and European revenues have increased from 5 per cent to 21 per cent in the period. The deal also gave Gland Pharma more capacity to make ampoules and pre-filled syringes, and added expertise in areas such as ophthalmic, hormonal and cytotoxic products.

According to the manage-

ment, the acquisition is also driving cross-selling opportunities in FY26 as well.

But EBITDA margins have declined post-acquisition despite revenue growth, as shown. Revenue growth will sustain as the company has added two products (inactivated vaccine and sterile gel supplies) from one facility, increased capacity from 8 million to 30 million ampoules in another and added new CDMO customers.

All these should support growth in the next two years.

In the last two quarters of FY26, Cenexi reported an EBITDA margin of 2 per cent compared with FY25/26 margins of -12.8/-1.7 per cent.

The margin improvement is on the back of higher capacity utilisation, inflation pass through, and optimisation of workforce, overheads, support and administrative expenses.

Gland Pharma aims for mid-teen EBITDA margins for Cenexi in FY27, as the reorganisation on expanded capacity materialises. This should improve the company's consolidated margin performance.

FINANCE, VALUATION

Gland Pharma reported revenue growth of 13 per cent CAGR in FY23-26 to ₹6,431 crore in FY26. The EBITDA growth was at 17 per cent CAGR in the period and

ACCUMULATE ON DIPS

Gland Pharma
₹2,479.70

WHY

- Revenue and margin improvement expected
- GLP-1 capacity in play
- Growing CDMO business

reported margin of 25.3 per cent in FY26. The company expects to sustain the revenue growth momentum in the medium term supported by: The three CDMO contracts, GPO purchase contracts, new product launches and expanded capacity.

The company intends to add ₹2,000 crore in the next five years in brownfield capacity expansion. This will expand existing capacity and add BFS (blow fill seal) capacity to support ophthalmic product range as well.

The company has a strong balance sheet and is a net cash company (net of debt). Also, the growth expectations exclude any possible contribution from GLP-1 segment owing to dependence on clients for approvals and launch timing, which are yet uncertain (though likely).

Consolidated EBITDA margins, which have been declining on account of the acquisition (as shown), are expected to improve along with Cenexi margin improvement.

The strong demand for outsourcing to India, Gland Pharma's proven track record and existing client relationships, and expansion in capacity and technology aspects along with scope for margin improvement should support strong earnings growth for Gland Pharma.

businessline's editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

How sectoral indices moved

	July 3	July 10	Movement	% change
REALTY	6,951.1	7,325.0	▲	5.4
CONSUMER DURABLES	60,699.4	62,002.7	▲	2.1
IT	26,730.5	27,211.9	▲	1.8
TECK	14,507.1	14,714.0	▲	1.4
METALS	40,547.7	40,816.6	▲	0.7
OIL&GAS	26,201.1	26,323.0	▲	0.5
CAPITAL GOODS	78,740.8	79,102.1	▲	0.5
BANKEX	65,450.3	65,687.7	▲	0.4
POWER	7,838.1	7,831.6	▼	-0.1
HEALTHCARE	50,088.5	49,941.1	▼	-0.3
PSU	20,912.7	20,791.6	▼	-0.6
AUTO	59,766.4	59,409.6	▼	-0.6
FMCG	18,629.0	18,408.6	▼	-1.2

WHO AM I?

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here's a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- I was founded about seven decades ago in a completely different business and evolved over the years to become a leader in my industry today.
- My CMD, whose father is my founder, graduated from the London School of Economics and earned an MBA from a prominent university in the US.
- I formed a JV with an MNC with centuries of credentials, and the JV created multi-billion-dollar wealth for me and my other partners through an IPO.
- My profits have grown over the previous one, three, five and 10 years, showing a consistency most businesses cannot match.
- Markets have rewarded my shareholders with about 10-fold returns over the last 10 years, despite my being in a non-glamorous business.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week's stock: Asahi India Glass
Last week's winner: Saji Antony

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,207) slipped 0.3 per cent over the past week, whereas Nifty Bank (58,046) edged up 0.2 per cent. The muted performance reflects a loss of momentum after the recovery seen over the preceding weeks. Renewed tensions between the US and Iran also weighed on sentiment as the earlier ceasefire came under renewed strain.

FII's (Foreign Institutional Investors) continued to maintain a bearish stance in index futures. Their net short position increased 2 per cent over the week to 2.55 lakh contracts.

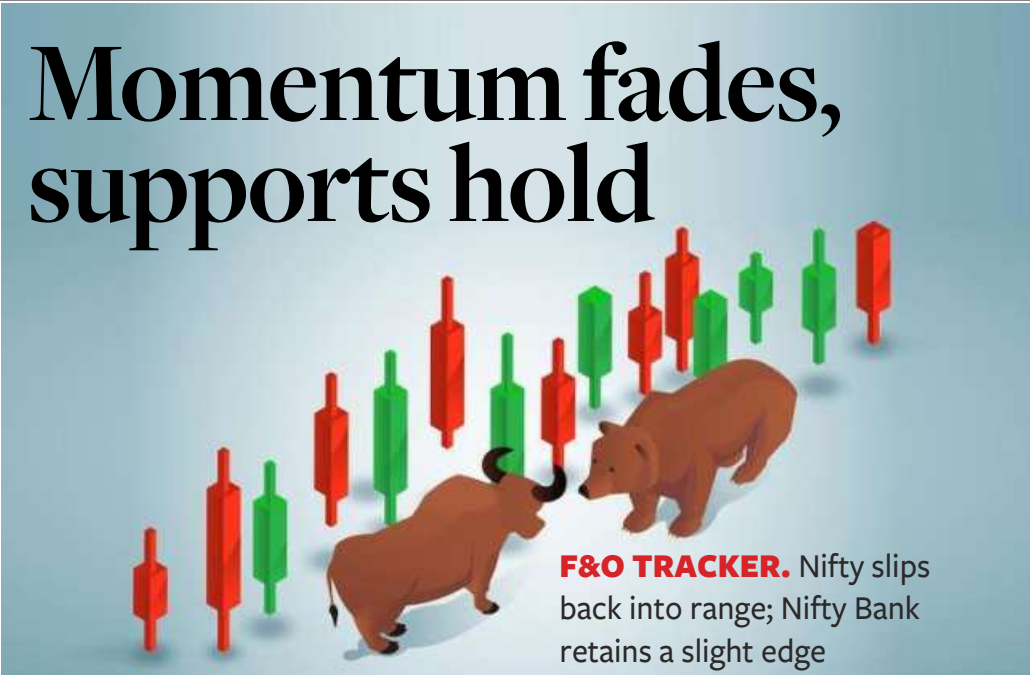
However, net short positions in index call options declined 6 per cent to 2.19 lakh contracts, while net long positions in index puts remained broadly unchanged at 4.79 lakh contracts. Thus, institutional positioning remains cautious, although bearish exposure in calls has moderated.

The broader positioning weakened further. Combined FII-retail net short positions on index futures increased 9 per cent from 78,070 contracts to 85,080 contracts. Net short positions in call options rose 24 per cent to 1.80 lakh contracts, indicating greater attempts to cap the upside. Net put shorts also increased 11 per cent to 1.51 lakh contracts, suggesting that traders continue to expect support at lower levels.

Overall, the derivatives data points to consolidation rather than an outright bearish reversal. Nifty appears relatively weaker after failing to sustain momentum above key resistance levels, whereas Bank Nifty continues to hold above important supports.

Therefore, the near-term direction is likely to depend on whether the indices break out of their prevailing ranges.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Jul) (24,242) remained volatile last week. After advancing in the early part of the week, the contract witnessed a sharp decline mid-week before recovering towards the close. Despite the rebound, it ended the



week 0.5 per cent lower.

As the contract declined, its open interest (OI) fell marginally by 2 per cent to 168 lakh contracts, indicating some long unwinding. While this does not signal a decisive bearish shift, it suggests that bullish momentum has moderated.

That said, the options segment continues to reflect a positive bias. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of July options stood at 1.14 on Friday. A PCR above 1 indicates relatively higher put writing, which is generally considered a favourable sign.

Overall, the derivatives data suggests that the recent uptrend has lost momentum, although it is too early to classify the move as a bearish reversal.

From a chart perspective, the support at 23,900 proved resilient despite last week's sell-off. In fact, the recovery in the latter half of the week emerged from this base. However, since the contract has slipped back below 24,300, the bulls will need to reclaim this level to regain momentum.

A breakout above 24,300 can revive the positive bias and potentially trigger a rally to 24,750. Note that 24,570 could act as an intermediate hurdle.

Conversely, if the contract breaks below 23,900, the outlook can turn bearish, opening the door for a decline to 23,600. A breach of

DERIVATIVE MARKET

- FII short positions rise
- Key supports hold
- Breakouts awaited

23,600 can accelerate the fall towards 23,250.

Overall, Nifty futures has slipped back into the 23,900-24,300 range. At this juncture, the direction of the next leg of the trend remains uncertain, although the broader price structure continues to exhibit a mildly positive bias.

Strategy: Since Nifty futures (Jul) slipped to an intra-week low of 23,842, the stop-loss at 23,900 on our recommended long position would have been triggered.

For fresh positions, wait for a breakout above 24,300 and then go long. Place stop-loss at 24,100 and book profits at 24,750.

NIFTY BANK

Nifty Bank futures (Jul) (58,200) also witnessed a decline last week but staged a stronger recovery than Nifty futures, enabling it to end the week broadly flat.

The OI eased marginally from 22.2 lakh contracts to 21.8 lakh contracts. Given the negligible price change, this decline in OI

does not offer any meaningful directional signal.

The PCR of July options improved from 0.85 to 0.94, indicating relatively higher put writing compared to call writing. This points to a moderation in bearish sentiment and lends support to the positive undertone.

While the derivatives data remains largely neutral, the chart indicates that Nifty Bank futures have rebounded sharply from the support zone around 57,000. Therefore, the 57,000-57,500 region remains a strong support band and suggests that the bulls continue to retain a slight edge.

A breakout above the immediate resistance at 58,700 can strengthen the bullish case and pave the way for a rally to 60,000. The next major resistance above that level is at 61,000.

On the other hand, if Nifty Bank futures slip below 57,000, the outlook can turn bearish. In such a scenario, the contract can decline to 56,000. The next notable support below that is at 55,000.

Strategy: The stop-loss at 57,400 on our recommended long position was triggered last week as Nifty Bank futures (Jul) touched an intra-week low of 56,704.

For fresh trades, buy Nifty Bank futures (Jul) on a breakout above 58,700. Place stop-loss at 58,000 and book profits at 60,000.

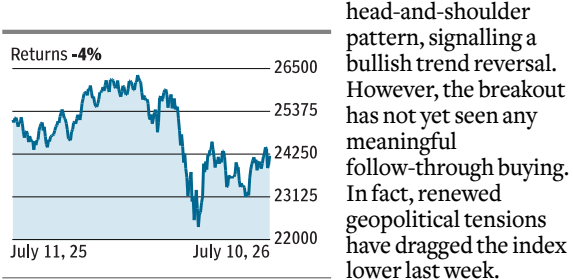
F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

You've written that Nifty 50 will touch 28,000 in long term. Taking this as cue, shall I buy December expiry Nifty 28,000-CE? Kindly advise
T C Rajashegaran

Nifty 50 (24,207): By the end of the week before the last one, the index confirmed an inverted



head-and-shoulder pattern, signalling a bullish trend reversal. However, the breakout has not yet seen any meaningful follow-through buying. In fact, renewed geopolitical tensions have dragged the index lower last week.

That said, Nifty 50

continues to hold above a key support at 23,800, which coincides with the 50-day moving average. Even if this level is breached, the index has additional support at 23,500 and 23,000.

The broader long-term outlook remains bullish as long as Nifty 50 stays above 22,000. However, a decline towards 23,500 or 23,000 could delay the anticipated rally towards 28,000. While a move to 28,000 appears achievable over the medium term, the timeline for such an advance remains uncertain, particularly given the current geopolitical backdrop.

Given the above factors, instead of buying the December 28,000-CE option (₹54.55), you may consider the December 26,000-CE option (₹333.55), as the probability of Nifty reaching 26,000 is considerably higher than it advancing to 28,000 by expiry.

Rather than deploying capital in a single tranche, the position can be built in two legs. Buy the first tranche at the current premium since there is a support nearby at 23,800 and add the second tranche once Nifty 50 decisively breaks above 24,600.

As for exits, consider booking profits on half the position when Nifty reaches 25,600 and hold the balance for a target of 26,200. On the downside, exit the positions if Nifty falls below the support at 23,000. This will serve as the stop-loss level.

All entry, exit and stop-loss decisions are based on the underlying Nifty 50 index rather than the option premium. This is because, over the coming months, the option's time value will significantly influence its premium, making the underlying index a more reliable reference point for trade management.

• Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Jul 10	Weekly change %	As on Jul 10	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	34427	16	230182	-4
Future Index Short	289138	3	60551	-10
Net Futures	-254711	2	169631	-2
Index Call options Long	520634	9	2678011	-14
Index Call options Short	739245	4	2639136	-12
Net Call options	-218611	-6	38875	-56
Index Put options Long	1058720	15	2788195	1
Index Put options Short	580162	31	3417713	2
Net Put Options	478558	0	-629518	3

FII's have marginally increased net short on index futures. But they've reduced net short on index calls. Not much change seen in net long on index puts over the last week. There are mixed signals.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Jul 10)				
TRENT	2,902.80	-13.1	312.7	99.5
COCHINSHIP	1,418.00	-7.0	151.3	93.9
KALYANKJIL	476.15	24.6	1135.0	82.4
LODHA	1,220.75	15.5	278.6	77.3
DRREDDY	1,244.30	-9.4	459.6	70.2
FALL (as on Jul 10)				
HEROMOTOCO	4,949.10	2.0	107.3	-16.7
360ONE	1,129.00	1.8	78.5	-14.3
MARICO	852.50	1.7	296.2	-13.2
POWERINDIA	32,605.00	5.0	11.3	-12.6
BAJAJ-AUTO	10,156.00	3.8	47.4	-12.4

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jul 13)

KAYNES

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
		(Weekly change %)		
COMMODITIES (as on Jul 10)				
ALUMINIUM	31-Jul	338.5 (2.5)	3,912 (-5)	Short covering
COPPER	31-Jul	1,293.6 (0.7)	12,355 (-7)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	20-Jul	6,814.0 (3.7)	18,749 (-6)	Short covering
CRUDEOILM	20-Jul	6,816.0 (3.8)	29,679 (-21)	Short covering
GOLD	5-Aug	143,478.0 (-2.6)	9,968 (-6)	Long unwinding
GOLDGUINEA	31-Jul	115,602.0 (-2.5)	16,472 (10)	Short build-up
GOLDM	5-Aug	143,376.0 (-2.6)	49,799 (3)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	31-Jul	14,442.0 (-2.6)	215,187 (3)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	31-Jul	143,682.0 (-2.6)	29,268 (-1)	Long unwinding
LEAD	31-Jul	200.7 (0.8)	538 (-1)	Short covering
NATURALGAS	28-Jul	280.3 (-9.7)	37,232 (76)	Short build-up
SILVER	4-Sep	222,664.0 (-6.2)	11,601 (2)	Short build-up
SILVERM	31-Aug	225,774.0 (-5.9)	28,340 (14)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	31-Aug	225,815.0 (-5.9)	100,070 (11)	Short build-up
ZINC	31-Jul	376.4 (2.6)	2,766 (6)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Jul 10)				
USDINR	29-Jul	95.53 (0.1)	12,84,621 (31)	Long build-up
EURINR	29-Jul	109.32 (-0.1)	5,784 (0)	-
GBPINR	29-Jul	128.36 (0.3)	26,742 (8)	Long build-up
JPYINR	29-Jul	59.40 (-0.1)	103 (24)	Short build-up

Trading advantages of Nifty options

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. As index options are cash-settled, you can avoid delivery margins

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy



Previously in this column, we discussed the advantages of trading index options. This week, continuing with this discussion, we look at the trading advantages of initiating index option positions. Specifically, Nifty Index options allow you to avoid margin requirements relating to delivery. Also, you can play the position till expiry.

SETTLEMENT STYLE

Trading advantages of Nifty Index options arises from the fact that such options are cash-settled. This is because when an index call option expires in-the-money (ITM), delivering all the constituents of the Nifty Index can be cumbersome. Note that it is mandatory to take delivery of shares when equity call options expire ITM. To reduce default during delivery on the expiry of an ITM equity call option, brokers collect delivery margins from the longs.

Weak bias returns

BULLION CUES. Key resistance levels hold

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Precious metals prices moderated last week. Gold (\$4,121/ounce) and silver (\$59.90/ounce) lost 1.3 and 4.1 per cent respectively.

Similarly, in the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,43,478/10 gm) were down 2.6 per cent and silver futures (₹2,22,664/kg) slipped 6.2 per cent.

MCX-Gold (₹1,43,478)

Gold futures (Aug), on the back of the 21-day moving average resistance at ₹1,48,000, saw a decline last week. The price action now hints that the contract has resumed the downtrend after a corrective rally.

As it stands, gold futures will most likely retest the support at ₹1,40,500. A breach of this can drag the contract lower to ₹1,38,000.

If the recovery gains traction and the contract surpasses the hurdle at ₹1,48,000, it can extend the upswing to ₹1,50,000.

Trade strategy: Although gold futures are likely to drop from the current level, the risk-reward ratio is not good for fresh

short positions now. Consider selling if the contract inches up to ₹1,46,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,40,500 and 1,48,500 respectively.

MCX-Silver (₹2,22,664)

Silver futures (Sep) fell off the barrier at ₹2,40,000 last week. This is a key level as both 21- and 50-day moving averages coincide here.

The decline is a likely indication that silver futures, after experiencing a corrective rise, has started to fall gain. While the nearest potential support is at ₹2,14,000, the contract might extend the decline to ₹2,12,000.

However, if silver futures rally and go above ₹2,40,000, it can strengthen further to ₹2,53,000.

Trade strategy: Sell silver futures at ₹2,30,000 with stop-loss at ₹2,41,000. Exit at ₹2,12,000.

Bounce may fade

CRUDE CHECK. Traders can consider selling

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



Oil prices snapped a four-week decline, as there was a recovery last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$76/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹6,814/barrel) gained 5.4 per cent and 3.7 per cent respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$76)

Brent crude futures rebounded on the back of the support at \$71. While it made a high of \$80.59 on Wednesday, the price slipped in the following sessions.

Thus, the resistance at \$80 holds true.

If the contract breaks out of \$80, it can extend the rally to \$86. However, the broader bias remains bearish and the recovery is likely to be capped.

There is a good chance for Brent crude futures to resume the decline from the current level of \$76 and test the support at \$71.

MCX Crude Oil (₹6,814)

Crude oil futures (July) found support at ₹6,400 and it bounced

off this level last week. It made a high of ₹7,296 on Wednesday before moderating and wrapping up the week at ₹6,814.

The chart shows that the price band of ₹7,300-7,500 is a notable barrier. Only a breakout of ₹7,500 can turn the outlook positive. In this case, crude oil futures can rally to the ₹8,000-8,100 resistance band, where the 50-day moving average lies.

The price action shows that the broader bias is negative and there is a good chance for crude oil futures to decline from the current level. The price can drop to ₹6,400. If this is invalidated, the contract can decline to ₹5,800.

Trade strategy: Short crude oil futures if the price inches up to ₹7,150. Target and stop-loss can be ₹6,400 and ₹7,500 respectively.

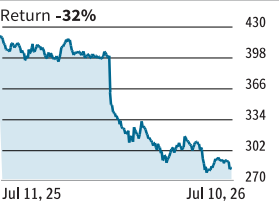
F&O Strategy

Buy ITC put option

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for the stock of ITC (₹281.75) remains negative. Immediate support levels are at ₹260 and ₹218. The close below the latter can trigger a fresh downside on ITC that can take it towards ₹186.

The stock finds an immediate resistance at ₹300 followed by ₹325. Only a close above the latter, will change the medium-term outlook positive for ITC. Overall, we expect the stock to continue with negative bias.



F&O pointers: ITC July futures closed at ₹282.95 against the spot close of ₹281.75. Open interests declined from 15.61 crore shares on June 30 to 14.09 crore shares currently. The stock witnessed unwinding of long positions in the last few days along with a fall in stock price. Options data indicates that ITC could move in the ₹260-290 range.

Strategy: Buy July expiry 280-put, which closed with a premium of ₹3.30 on Friday. As the market lot is 1,725 shares, the strategy would cost ₹5,692.50. This would be the maximum loss and that will happen if ITC remains above ₹280 on expiry. Profit potentials are high if the stock falls sharply.

Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2.5. This can be shifted to ₹3 if the stock opens on a steady note. Traders can aim for a target of ₹4-4.25.

Follow-up: We had advised going long on Asian Paints. Stop-loss would have triggered as the price fell sharply due to renewed US-Iran dispute.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

Historical Vs implied volatility

bl. research bureau

When it comes to trading, it is imperative to understand volatility. Volatility is the amount of variation of a price of a security over a particular time irrespective of the direction. It is also considered as the measure of risk — a security with higher volatility is deemed to be riskier — it can undergo a considerable amount of change in price. But that is where the opportunity lies as well. There are two types of volatility — historical volatility (HV) and implied volatility (IV).



Historical volatility: Historical volatility of a security tells us about how volatile it has been in the past over a particular period — it is backward looking. Importantly, HV can change based on the time period that we look into. For instance, the HV of a stock in the last six months and in the last one year can be different.

Implied volatility: Implied volatility is the assumed or the estimated volatility — it indicates the level of volatility that the market expects going forward. IV is calculated using the price of option contracts of that security. For example, India VIX is the measure of IV of Nifty 50, which shows the market expectations of volatility in the index over the next 30 calendar days. It is calculated using prices of out-of-the-money option contracts. But generally, IV has always overstated the actual volatility.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Last week, we had said that the Nifty 50 and Sensex are looking bullish with an inverted head and shoulder pattern formation. This pattern has failed. The sharp fall on Wednesday, after the US announced that the ceasefire was over, played the spoil sport.

Although the pattern has failed, the broader picture remains positive. The recovery towards the end of the week indicates the presence of buyers in the market at lower levels. The Sensex and Nifty which were down about 2 per cent mid-week have recovered and closed the week marginally lower by 0.25 per cent each. As such, the development on the US-Iran war front has not changed anything on our overall bullish outlook.

FPIs BUY

The foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) continue to buy Indian equities. The equity segment saw a net inflow of about \$1.59 billion so far in July. There has been an inflow of about \$3 billion in the last four weeks. Are the FPIs coming back? We need to wait and watch. If the FPIs increase their pace of purchase, then the Sensex and Nifty can scale new highs in the coming months.

NIFTY 50 (24,206.90)

Short-term view: The support at 23,800 continues to hold well. That keeps the bias positive. Immediate resistance is at 24,350. A break above it can strengthen the momentum. Such a break can take the Nifty up to 24,800 in the short term.

Failure to breach 24,350 can drag the Nifty down to 24,000-23,900. In that case, Nifty can remain in a range of 23,800-24,350 for some time.

The short-term picture will turn negative only if the index declines below 23,800. If that happens, a fall to 23,500 and even lower can be seen.

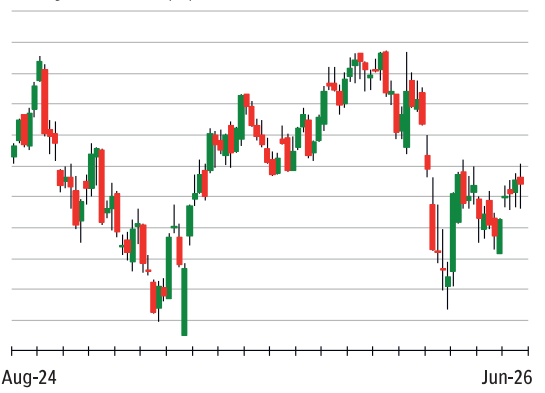
Medium-term view: The broader 22,000-26,500 range is intact. Within that, Nifty is moving up and is expected to rise towards 26,500, the upper end of the range. A break above 24,800 will clear the way for this rise.

The long-term picture remains positive to get a bullish breakout above 26,500 eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty higher to 28,000 and even 30,000 in the long term.

Holding steady

INDEX OUTLOOK. Broader outlook remains positive in spite of the failed head and shoulder pattern

Nifty 50: Support holds well



A fall below 22,000 is needed to negate this bullish view.

NIFTY BANK (58,045.90)

Short-term view: Except for the high volatility, the Nifty Bank index oscillated well within its 56,500-58,900 range. The near-term picture continues to remain unclear. We have to wait for a breakout on either side of 56,500-58,900 to get clarity on the next move.

The bias is positive. So, we see higher chances for the index to breach 58,900 and rise to 60,500-61,500 in the short term.

The outlook will turn negative only if the index declines below 56,500. In that case, 56,000 or even 55,000 can be seen on the downside.

Our preference is to see a bullish breakout above 58,900.

Medium-term view: The overall bullish picture is intact. Key resistance to watch will be

61,500. A break above it will clear the way for a rise to 65,000 in the medium term. From a long-term perspective, there is potential for the Nifty Bank index to target 68,000-69,000.

Crucial supports are at 53,500 and 50,000. The above-mentioned bullish view will turn wrong only if the Nifty Bank index declines below 50,000. But that looks unlikely now.

SENSEX (77,569.39)

Short-term view: The 76,300-76,000 support zone mentioned last week has held very well. Sensex touched a low of 76,259 and has recovered from there.

Immediate support is at 77,100. A rise to 78,250 or even 78,800 looks likely this week. A decisive break above 78,800 will boost the momentum and can take the index up to 81,000-81,500 in the short term.

Key support to watch will be

IMMEDIATE RESISTANCE

- Nifty 50: 24,350
- Sensex: 78,800
- Nifty Bank: 58,900

76,000. The short-term outlook will turn negative if the Sensex declines below this support. In that case, a fall to 74,000-73,000 is possible.

Medium-term view: For now, the 71,000-86,000 range is intact and the Sensex can go up within it. A rise above 81,500 will increase the chances of seeing 86,000, the upper end of the range, in the medium term.

We expect the Sensex to breach 86,000 eventually and rally to 90,000 and even 94,000 over the long term.

This bullish view will go wrong only if the Sensex declines below 71,000.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (23,166.50)

The index broke the support at 22,600 but did not sustain. It has risen back from the low of 22,431.35 recovering all the loss. The index is now coming close to the crucial resistance level of 23,300. We expect it to breach this hurdle and rise to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term. Such rise will strengthen the momentum and keep the doors open for a rally to 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

Failure to breach 23,300 can drag the index down to 22,800-

22,700. The index has to get a sustained fall below 22,500 to turn the short-term picture negative. Only then a fall to 22,000 and lower levels will come into the picture.

We reiterate that 21,000-20,800 is a crucial support which has to be broken to turn the long-term outlook bearish.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (18,118.90)

The support 17,500 continued to limit the downside for the third consecutive week. The strong bounce from the low of 17,526 keeps the chances high to breach the resistance at 18,300 this week. Such a break will boost the momentum. It will also clear the way for the Nifty Smallcap 250 index to rally to 22,500-23,000 in the medium term and 24,000-25,000 in the long term.

The index will come under pressure for a fall to 17,000-16,500 only if it breaks below 17,500. For this to happen, the index has to get a strong selling from around 18,300,



Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English



Tamil

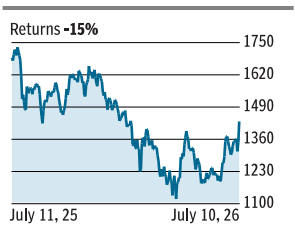


MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

CDSL (₹1,431.90)

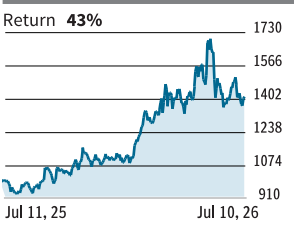
Trend turns bullish



level, we might see some moderation in price, probably to ₹1,370. But then, the stock can resume the rally and eventually rise to ₹1,800 over the medium term. Buy now at ₹1,431 and ₹1,370. Place stop-loss at ₹1,275. When the price rises to ₹1,560 and ₹1,680, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,460 and ₹1,600 respectively. Exit at ₹1,800.

Great Eastern Shipping Company (₹1,422)

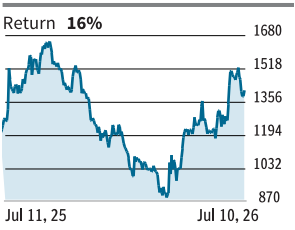
Hovering near a base



the uptrend begins, the stock can rally to ₹1,680. But note that there might be some consolidation or a minor correction around the resistance at ₹1,535. Go long at ₹1,422 and ₹1,360. Stop-loss can be ₹1,315. When the price rises to ₹1,535 and ₹1,620, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,400 and ₹1,550 respectively. Exit at ₹1,680.

Olectra Greentech (₹1,423.50)

Uptrend intact



uptrend. We expect the bulls to gain traction soon and establish another leg up, potentially lifting the price to ₹1,850 over the medium term. Buy now at ₹1,423 and accumulate at ₹1,360. Place stop-loss at ₹1,150. When the price rises to ₹1,650 and ₹1,770, alter the stop-loss to ₹1,500 and ₹1,700 respectively. Book profits at ₹1,850.

More upside left

US MARKET OUTLOOK. The benchmark indices have more room to rise

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average is struggling to rise while the S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices are slowly gaining strength. The Dow Jones was down 0.5 per cent for the week. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices were up 1.2 and 1.7 per cent respectively last week.

Last week, we had cautioned about getting a trend reversal. It looks like this reversal can now happen with a slight delay. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite indices have room to rise more before a hitting a peak. To that extent, the Dow Jones can also manage to hold higher.

Here is an analysis on where the US markets are headed going forward.

DOW JONES (52,642.27)

The index broke the crucial resistance level of 53,150 last week but did not sustain. At the same time, the support at 52,000 is also holding well for now.

We can expect the Dow Jones to remain in a range of 52,000-53,300 for some time. If it manages to breach 53,300, an extended rise to 54,000 can be seen.

As mentioned last week, a fall below 52,000 will indicate that a top is in place. It will then turn the outlook bearish for a fall to 50,000-49,000 thereafter. We will have to wait and watch.

S&P 500 (7,575.38)

The way the S&P 500 index is holding above 7,400 and the rise last week indicates that the bullish picture is still intact. That keeps alive the chances of a rise to 7,800-7,900. A decisive break above 7,600 can trigger this rise.

The index will come under pressure for a fall to 7,200-7,100 only on a break below 7,400. Also, a sustained fall below 7,100 is needed to indicate that trend has reversed.

For now, the picture is positive and the rise to 7,800-7,900 is



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

● BULLISH BIAS

As long as the dollar index remains above 100.60, the bias is bullish to see 103 and higher levels

likely to be seen first.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,281.61)

The support 25,600 has held very well. The NASDAQ Composite index has bounced back well from its low of 25,526. The rise above 26,000 has eased the downside pressure. A strong follow-through rise from here can take the NASDAQ Composite index up to 27,500-28,000 in the coming weeks. The price action thereafter will need a close watch.

A rise beyond 28,000 might not be very easy. As such, we need to be very cautious as the index approaches 28,000.

The level of 25,000 is an important support. The short-term outlook will turn negative if the index breaks below 25,000. Such a break can drag it down to 24,000.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (100.97) oscillated around 101 all through the week. The support at 100.60 mentioned last week is holding very well. As long as the index stays above 100.60, there is no change in our bullish bias.

We expect the dollar index to get a sustained break above 101. Such a break can take it higher towards 103 in the coming weeks. It will also keep the upside open to see 105-106 over the medium term.

The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index breaks below 100.60. If that happens, a fall to 99.30 can be seen. That in turn may negate the bullish view of seeing 105-106.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.56 per cent) seems to be struggling to get a strong follow-through rise above 4.55 per cent. The bias is positive. A rise above 4.6 per cent can boost the momentum. Such a break can take the 10Yr Treasury yield higher to 4.8 per cent in the coming weeks.

The yield has to decline below 4.35 per cent to come under pressure for a fall to 4.25 per cent or even lower.

TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl. research bureau

I have bought KPIT Technologies shares at ₹608. What is the outlook?

K S Dhami

KPIT Technologies (₹562): The stock has been knocked down badly in the last couple of years. The price has tumbled over 70 per cent from a high of around ₹1,928 (July 2024). The strong fall below ₹600 last week has brought renewed pressure. Resistance is at ₹620. As long as the stock trades below it, the outlook will remain negative. Support is around ₹500. A break below it will see the stock tumbling towards ₹300 in the coming months.

Since there is no scope for a price rise, exit the stock and accept the loss. Always have a stop-loss in the first place whenever you enter any trade. That will help in minimising the loss. It will also help to avoid getting stuck in a wrong position for a long time.

Is it a good time to buy Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) shares now long-term? Please advise

Anil Kuyilath

ONGC (₹245): The stock has very crucial supports in the ₹230-₹200 region. From a long-term perspective, there are good chances for the share price to go up again to ₹350 over the next one year. From a multi-year perspective, say for a five-year period, there is potential to see ₹520 on the upside. You can buy the stock in three tranches. Buy 40 per cent of the intended amount now at current levels. Buy another 40 per cent at ₹230 and the balance

at ₹220. Keep a stop-loss at ₹155. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹280 when the price goes up to ₹330. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹340 and ₹430 when the price touches ₹420 and ₹490 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹520.

What is the technical outlook for Indraprastha Medical Corporation?

Rahamath M, Coimbatore

Indraprastha Medical Corporation (₹380): The stock is struggling to get a sustained rise past ₹440 since the beginning of this year. That keeps alive the danger of the price declining below the crucial support level of ₹345. If this break happens, the price can fall to ₹300-₹295 thereafter. A strong and sustained rise above ₹440 is needed to strengthen the bullish case. Only then the upside will open up for a fresh rally to ₹730. For now, it is better to

stay out of this stock. You can consider entering this stock after the breakout above ₹440 happens. In that case, you can keep a stop-loss at ₹320 and play for the target of ₹730. For every ₹100 rise in the share price, move your stop-loss also up by ₹100.

I have bought Everest Kanto Cylinder shares at ₹154. What is the outlook?

Nikesh

Everest Kanto Cylinder (₹115): The trend is down since December 2024. There is no concrete sign of a bullish trend reversal. Important resistance is at ₹140. A

break above it will give some breather and take the stock price higher to ₹180-₹185. This will be an initial sign of a trend reversal. Ideally, a rise above ₹185 will only turn the outlook convincingly bullish for a rise to ₹250. But failure to rise past ₹140 from here can keep the

stock under pressure. In that case, the downside will remain open to see ₹85 and even lower. Since the rise to ₹180 does not look very certain from here, it is not advisable to accumulate at current levels. So, it is better to exit the stock and accept the loss.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

BANDU'S PICKS	These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner L Bhuvaneswari
	1 Ather Energy	Last week's winning stock Lodha Developers
	2 Firstsource Solutions	Closing price (July 3) ₹1,057.10
	3 Gravita India	Closing price (July 10) ₹1,221.15
	4 Godrej Properties	Return: 15.52 per cent
	5 Chennai Petroleum Corporation	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valueuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.3 per cent each last week. BSE Realty gained the most by 5.4 per cent, followed by BSE Consumer Durables 2.1 per cent and BSE IT 2.1 per cent. BSE FMCG and BSE Auto declined by 1.2 and 0.6 per cent respectively last week.

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low	
360 ONE [1]	1129.4	29.9	37.8	4.7	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	1.8	14.3	0.0	1235.7	906.2	
3M India [3]	35357.3	542.7	65.2	18.6	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	0.5	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28747.3	
A B B [2]	6833.6	71.9	95.1	18.5	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	-1.7	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5	
A B Lifestyle [2]	95.6	1.7	56.0	8.3	202603	11.9	57.7	7.2	29.4	-2.3	-11.7	2.3	166.1	87.7	
A B Real Estate [2]	1443.6	-27.0	4.4	2.0603	-79.1	-878.4	-66.4	-60.4	-2.7	-4.7	1.4	2254.0	1080.1		
Aadhar Hsg. Fin. [2]	553.9	25.1	21.1	3.1	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	-1.1	11.4	2.8	563.0	425.1	
AAJFINS [2]	484.2	1.1	412.6	3.0	202603	13.1	47.1	14.1	25.2	-0.7	6.2	0.7	527.9	338.2	
AAVAS Financiers [2]	1523.2	61.9	24.6	3.2	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	1.1	9.9	0.2	2040.0	1050.3	
Abbott India [2]	27125.0	730.4	37.1	12.1	202603	6.5	7.6	8.1	9.7	-4.0	45.0	0.35280	25164.0		
ACC [2]	1394.8	112.4	12.3	1.3	202603	16.9	62.9	17.3	-9.0	-0.6	11.2	0.0	2027.8	1250.9	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	376.9	1.7	53.0	3.4	202603	12.5	0.9	44.0	87.6	-1.7	7.4	2.8	398.2	174.6	
Action Const.Eng. [2]	899.4	34.9	28.4	5.9	202603	7.1	-6.5	-1.4	-1.4	-0.1	0.2	0.0	122.0	746.1	
Acuteas Chemical [5]	3394.0	43.5	78.0	16.8	202603	40.3	110.9	33.0	124.5	-8.0	20.1	0.1	3735.0	111.0	
Adani Energy Sol. [2]	1654.2	19.0	87.1	7.8	202603	16.8	5.7	16.1	-6.0	5.4	9.5	1.9	1711.7	745.5	
Adani Enterp. [1]	3155.2	16.1	196.2	4.5	202603	20.3	-124.0	2.6	-48.0	-1.8	5.6	1.5	3245.0	1735.3	
Adani Green [2]	1536.3	18.1	137.0	13.1	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	-1.3	8.0	0.7	1588.8	767.0	
Adani Ports [2]	1828.0	56.3	32.4	4.4	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	-2.5	13.8	0.7	1891.8	1291.0	
Adani Power [2]	218.4	6.7	32.8	6.8	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-1.5	16.6	0.8	254.2	11.0	
Adani Total Gas [1]	724.1	6.0	121.4	16.4	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	0.3	14.8	0.5	859.7	453.5	
Aditya AMC [5]	144.9	33.8	33.9	8.2	202603	6.9	18.0	9.5	5.0	-2.8	32.2	0.0	122.0	708.9	
Aditya Bkr. Fas. [2]	60.1	-6.1	1.3	1.3	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-4.0	0.0	1.3	95.0	53.6	
Aditya Birla Cap. [2]	408.9	13.9	29.4	2.9	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	1.7	9.5	4.4	410.7	244.0	
Aditya Infotech [1]	3667.2	13.2	117.4	23.0	202603	45.5	20.7	35.6	160.5	2.1	19.3	0.6	3791.9	1014.7	
Aegis Logistics [1]	1252.4	25.6	48.9	10.9	202603	52.2	45.7	23.2	35.4	-5.5	24.5	0.9	2421.9	1976.0	
Aegis Vopak Term. [2]	283.3	2.3	124.3	7.7	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	9.6	7.0	2.5	320.0	158.8	
Aether Industri. [2]	1495.7	17.0	87.7	8.1	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	9.9	9.7	0.1	1538.4	723.2	
Aikons Infrastr. [2]	300.6	8.5	35.5	2.0	202603	-18.9	-179.7	-4.8	36.0	-3.8	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.9	
Airtel [2]	1480.5	23.3	45.8	1.9	202603	17.7	26.0	25.2	15.0	-1.1	16.6	0.1	2188.2	121.9	
AIA Engineering [2]	4675.8	136.4	34.3	5.4	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	-19.0	-1.7	19.1	0.1	5175.0	3006.6	
Ajanta Pharma [2]	3351.2	84.5	39.6	9.3	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	0.8	31.8	0.0	3505.6	2335.0	
Alkem Lab [2]	5669.7	201.8	28.1	4.9	202603	14.6	3.6	13.5	11.4	1.8	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4716.8	
AILW Blenders [2]	640.6	8.2	78.7	10.9	202603	17.7	12.4	17.1	13.1	-0.6	11.8	0.5	840.0	382.7	
Alok Industries [1]	12.6	-1.6	-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	-4.6	-0.0	0.0	2.3	12.2	11.1	
Amaraj Raja Ener. [1]	887.7	38.5	23.1	2.0	202603	15.5	11.6	7.5	-18.9	3.6	15.6	0.0	1058.0	671.1	
Amber Enterp. [2]	7780.8	57.1	36.3	6.3	202603	10.5	-26.8	12.2	17.3	-4.0	13.5	0.8	8970.0	5404.0	
Amulja Cement [2]	436.3	20.0	21.8	1.8	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.6	-1.5	14.5	0.0	626.0	394.0	
Anand Rathi Wea. [2]	2150.4	27.8	77.2	34.8	202606	18.2	77.0	22.9	46.6	4.3	57.1	0.1	2215.4	1050.0	
Anant Raj [2]	586.1	15.4	38.0	3.6	202603	19.6	23.6	21.9	30.4	5.6	10.9	0.1	744.1	403.0	
Angel One [1]	346.1	10.0	34.6	5.2	202603	38.2	83.5	-1.9	-21.9	-1.7	14.8	1.0	360.2	280.9	
Angel Biotech [2]	1151.6	62.9	18.0	4.0	202603	5.5	12.8	5.9	13.2	0.0	59.3	0.0	1151.6	13.2	
Apur Industries [2]	14086.8	249.1	16.5	10.5	202603	26.6	4.7	27.3	23.3	21.6	0.6	32.6	0.1	17149.0	4880.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1835.2	43.3	42.4	9.6	202603	14.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-2.6	22.0	0.2	11740.0	1493.0	
Apollo Hospitals [5]	8841.6	136.0	65.0	13.4	202603	18.1	35.9	15.8	16.3	-0.6	17.5	0.6	8948.1	6680.0	
Apollo Tyres [2]	33.6	13.1	1.7	202603	14.2	254.7	10.0	72.5	-2.0	13.4	0.3	30.3	365.4	21.0	
Apurva Value Hold. [2]	283.8	1.6	178.0	10.7	202603	26.0	25.2	16.0	15.4	-0.4	0.1	264.0	135.5		
Asahi India Glas [1]	915.1	13.9	66.0	5.9	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	1.7	4.9	13.1	0.9	1073.0	775.1	
Ashok Leyland [1]	157.6	6.4	24.8	6.5	202603	17.1	9.0	15.9	20.9	-4.1	14.9	4.3	215.4	11.0	
Aster Frimts [1]	2677.8	46.3	57.9	12.0	202603	18.2	36.6	53.1	22.2	-0.3	0.2	2985.5	2116.0		
Aster DM Health. [2]	808.8	10.3	78.9	9.9	202603	18.2	39.1	12.2	17.6	-0.7	11.8	0.5	840.0	519.8	
Astral [1]	133.7	20.6	64.8	8.8	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	15.6	-3.2	20.8	0.1	176.0	1262.8	
Ather Energy [1]	1224.3	13.4	18.2	202603	73.7	-142.8	62.8	36.9	8.3	0.0	1.1	1242.8	32.7		
Atul [2]	6237.3	23.3	27.1	3.0	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-4.4	14.9	0.0	7617.0	5563.0	
Aura Financial [2]	107.24	35.304	3.04	4.1	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	1.4	0.0	0.0	109.04	62.55	
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	864.7	61.1	25.6	2.4	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	1.8	-3.4	14.2	0.2	1636.0	1017.0	
Aurum Invest [1]	513.8	22.7	22.6	3.0	202603	-78.6	-96.6	-43.0	-54.5	-2.1	29.7	0.1	683.5	40.0	
Avenue Super. [2]	408.1	45.5	89.7	10.9	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	-2.3	18.0	0.0	491.6	352.8	
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	190.0	8.2	23.3	2.4	202603	5.3	15.5	17.3	13.4	-0.6	17.1	0.2	285.3	171.2	
Axis Bank [2]	1323.8	84.8	15.6	1.9	202603	3.7	1.7	4.1	-6.0	-1.4	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3	

BHEL [2]	395.3	4.6	86.0	5.3	202603	36.9	155.8	19.2	199.7	3.1	3.2	0.4	424.9	205.2
BPCL [2]	309.7	60.3	5.1	1.3	202603	6.7	26.1	3.4	92.1	0.5	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [2]	10163.4	385.4	26.4	7.3	202603	40.2	101.6	22.6	47.1	3.9	28.4	0.4	10835.0	7879.5
Bajaj Finance [1]	1202.5	30.8	33.1	5.6	202603	18.4	22.0	19.4	15.4	-1.2	10.9	0.3	1310.2	788.6
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1915.6	62.9	30.5	3.9	202603	5.3	0.0	13.2	13.4	0.0	11.8	0.2	2194.7	1598.7
Bajaj Holdings [2]	10662.8	736.5	14.5	1.6	202603	-58.3	49.2	56.3	25.7	-3.7	12.6	0.1	10475.3	8597.5
Bajaj Housing [2]	88.1	3.1	28.5	3.3	202603	15.7	14.1	16.6	18.8	-3.6	8.8	4.4	124.1	72.6
Balrashtra India [2]	2253.9	64.1	35.1	4.0	202603	6.6	18.7	3.6	24.9	1.5	10.9	0.4	2800.2	1971.5
Banglarampur Chini [1]	566.4	17.9	31.6	2.6	202603	6.7	30.4	15.8	13.4	0.5	11.1	0.6	627.0	393.4
Bandhan Bank [2]	210.3	7.6	7.7	1.3	202603	-0.1	68.0	-1.2	-55.4	-0.8	0.0	0.0	218.4	134.3
Bank of Baroda [2]	251.0	38.4	6.5	0.8	202603	5.2	7.0	4.6	-4.2	-0.5	0.0	0.0	325.6	231.0
Bank of India [2]	144.9	23.5	6.2	0.8	202603	5.9	18.7	6.0	11.9	0.5	0.0	0.0	178.5	109.0
Bank of Maharashtra [2]	546.8	37.2	14.7	1.8	202603	13.9	34.5	15.8	31.0	-0.7	0.0	0.0	645.0	437.0
Bank of Mysore [2]	691.6	12.8	53.8	5.6	202603	18.2	18.2	18.2	18.2	-0.8	14.6	0.0	1287.9	605.6
Bank of North East India [2]	431.8	153.4	26.9	6.3	202603	5.2	13.1	3.7	21.3	-0.2	23.8	0.0	954.0	503.0
Bayer Crop Sci. [2]	251.1	5.6	41.1	3.9	202603	12.2	17.5	14.7	40.8	0.1	14.1	1.1	252.0	130.0
BEML India [5]	1864.1	17.0	109.7	5.3	202603	8.6	-37.5	8.2	-51.7	-0.2	11.7	0.1	2365.0	1361.1
Bharat Electronics [2]	132.7	1.9	45.5	3.4	202603	12.5	10.0	12.5	10.0	-0.4	11.0	0.0	132.7	12.5
Bharat Dynamics [5]	134.9	11.5	117.3	11.6	202603	-72.9	-58.5	-27.3	-23.5	-3.2	10.2	0.0	1980.0	1090.0
Bharat Electron [1]	414.9	8.3	50.0	12.6	202603	17.1	4.6	16.2	13.9	-0.7	36.9	0.0	473.0	361.1
Bharat Forge [2]	2116.1	24.6	86.1	10.6	202603	17.5	2.1	11.2	18.8	-1.0	11.7	0.9	2237.0	360.1
Bharat Heavy [2]	141.2	1.9	45.5	3.4	202603	12.5	10.0	12.5	10.0	-0.4	11.0	0.0	141.2	12.5
Bharat Hexacom [2]	1606.3	35.1	45.7	11.2	202603	5.4	-1.1	9.4	35.6	10.5	16.5	1.5	1955.0	1431.0
Bikaji Foods [1]	643.1	10.4	61.7	10.0	202603	19.0	26.1	15.1	30.2	-2.8	18.4	0.2	820.0	59.0
Billombrains [2]	204.6	3.3	61.6	13.3	202603	87.9	122.1	19.0	14.2	-0.9	61.6	0.1	227.0	112.0
Birla Finance [2]	419.2	110.2	3.7	1.3	202603	12.5	10.0	12.5	10.0	-0.4	11.0	0.0	419.2	12.5
Birlasoft India [2]	290.1	19.4	15.0	2.0	202603	2.4	44.1	-1.2	-4.9	-2.7	20.0	0.0	473.8	270.2
BLS Internet [1]	237.3	16.7	14.2	4.0	202603	17.6	31.6	36.7	35.1	-6.5	39.0	0.1	415.0	218.5
Blue Dart Express [2]	4918.7	119.9	41.0	6.6	202603	8.2	11.9	7.4	11.9	-0.4	25.8	0.1	4639.0	263.0
Blue Star [2]	1661.3	27.0	61.6	10.0	202603	13.3	10.4	3.6	-4.6	-4.9	25.8	0.1	2050.0	1540.0
Bombardier [2]	4180.7	789.4	53.0	8.3	202603	13.3	3.0	10.8	15.6	-0.2	20.5	0.0	4225.0	2865.0
Brainbees Solut. [2]	212.0	-2.5	2.3	2.0	202603	12.0	-123.1	11.6	10.2	-3.3	0.0	0.4	438.7	27.0
Brigade Star [2]	574.4	10.1	28.6	2.0	202603	-7.2	-4.2	11.2	11.2	-0.2	11.2	0.0	574.4	10.1
Britannia Inds. [1]	5353.7	105.2	50.9	25.3	202603	7.1	21.1	7.5	15.3	-0.4	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5038.0



bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.6	16692	1.4	0.5	-3.3	10.6	10.1	13.3	0.28
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	109.1	79421	1.1	0.7	-1.9	13.1	13.5	13.6	0.43
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	90.1	53227	1.2	0.6	-1.3	13.1	15.2	14.2	0.48
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1137.0	39024	1.5	1.0	-0.8	11.2	12.8	12.8	0.37
*****	JM Large Cap	152.6	409	2.1	0.8	-1.2	11.3	11.5	10.9	0.32
*****	Kotak Large Cap	567.8	10772	1.8	0.7	-1.8	11.2	10.7	12.2	0.30
*****	SBI Large Cap	94.1	55064	1.2	0.7	0.4	10.3	11.2	12.0	0.34
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	517.7	29029	1.4	0.8	-3.0	10.8	11.1	11.7	0.31
***	Bandhan Large Cap	78.2	2061	1.8	0.8	1.4	12.9	12.0	12.6	0.32
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	218.5	2571	1.7	0.7	-2.1	12.0	11.5	12.3	0.33
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	82.9	1434	1.8	0.6	-2.3	10.1	10.8	12.3	0.30
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1014.0	7256	1.5	0.9	-1.7	10.7	9.1	10.5	0.24
***	Invesco India Largecap	71.5	1847	1.8	0.7	1.9	13.9	12.7	12.8	0.35
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	112.5	38379	1.3	0.5	-1.2	9.9	9.4	12.7	0.25
***	Tata Large Cap	510.3	2721	1.7	0.8	0.7	11.5	11.3	11.8	0.32
***	UTI Large Cap	264.5	11976	1.9	1.1	-4.3	8.6	8.6	11.2	0.21
**	DSP Large Cap	461.2	7175	1.5	0.7	-3.5	12.8	10.7	11.2	0.32
**	HSBC Large Cap	475.7	1814	1.8	1.0	0.3	11.0	10.4	12.0	0.32
**	LIC MF Large Cap	53.5	1362	1.8	0.9	-5.6	8.0	7.8	10.2	0.18
**	Union Largecap	23.2	437	2.1	1.3	-2.5	9.0	9.3	-	0.24
*	Axis Large Cap	59.8	30913	1.3	0.6	-2.0	9.0	7.3	11.8	0.15
*	Groww Largecap	43.1	132	2.4	1.1	-0.3	10.9	10.4	10.9	0.27
*	PGIM India Large Cap	331.5	539	2.1	0.8	-3.4	7.4	7.4	9.9	0.17
-	Mah Manu Large Cap	22.2	700	2.0	0.6	-5.2	9.5	9.4	-	0.24
-	Taurus Large Cap	158.9	52	2.1	1.9	0.4	13.0	10.8	10.0	0.27
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	141.0	18783	1.4	0.5	5.5	20.1	17.3	15.6	0.51
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	347.9	29285	1.6	0.9	1.0	15.7	16.0	14.8	0.47
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1037.5	30971	1.3	0.7	3.1	17.6	17.7	15.4	0.58
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	34.6	16469	1.4	0.6	5.7	15.7	12.8	-	0.35
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	124.5	3450	1.7	0.6	5.5	16.8	16.2	15.4	0.44
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	654.0	40850	1.3	0.6	4.0	14.8	14.2	14.9	0.45
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	186.4	6218	1.9	1.0	2.6	17.5	15.4	14.1	0.48
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	92.9	491	2.1	1.0	4.8	15.1	12.8	12.8	0.36
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	254.8	25251	1.4	0.5	-1.5	13.4	11.7	14.8	0.32
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	627.1	17370	1.4	0.5	0.4	16.3	13.1	14.6	0.39
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	90.1	4683	1.6	0.5	2.9	15.4	13.5	14.6	0.39
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	110.0	11164	1.5	0.5	9.0	24.1	17.9	16.6	0.47
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	354.6	31263	1.6	0.6	2.9	15.5	14.5	15.2	0.42
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	157.7	44048	1.3	0.5	4.2	14.5	12.3	16.6	0.34
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1491.6	7459	1.5	1.0	1.2	17.1	15.1	13.1	0.45
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	191.9	3450	1.7	1.1	-1.2	13.5	11.2	11.6	0.30
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	39.4	3093	1.7	0.6	0.5	15.4	12.8	14.4	0.35
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	91.4	6991	1.8	0.8	6.8	15.2	13.6	14.6	0.37
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	504.8	7887	1.5	0.6	-5.3	8.7	10.9	12.4	0.29
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	937.6	5784	1.6	0.9	2.8	12.8	9.1	11.5	0.21
*	Navi Large & Midcap	36.5	310	2.1	0.5	2.4	10.0	11.4	12.7	0.31
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	29.5	5344	1.6	0.7	10.5	18.9	15.3	-	0.37
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	2036.5	106496	1.3	0.7	2.4	17.3	18.1	15.9	0.60
*****	JM Flexicap	97.9	5178	1.6	0.6	-0.7	16.0	16.6	16.3	0.47
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.9	143388	1.1	0.5	-2.2	14.3	13.6	16.9	0.50
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.8	3484	1.7	0.5	1.4	14.9	13.2	14.4	0.37
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1611.8	19274	1.4	0.8	-2.7	14.1	13.8	13.1	0.39
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	36.5	5818	1.9	0.6	-0.1	9.8	8.9	13.6	0.23
*****	Union Flexi Cap	52.1	2376	1.7	0.8	0.4	12.2	11.3	13.1	0.31
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1919.0	26727	1.4	0.7	6.3	16.0	12.5	14.1	0.35
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	211.3	7417	1.5	0.9	0.6	12.9	11.5	10.9	0.31
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	342.2	13328	1.5	0.5	-0.3	12.0	10.9	14.1	0.30
***	DSP Flexi Cap	104.1	11798	1.5	0.6	0.1	13.3	10.9	14.1	0.29
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	227.1	5633	1.6	0.9	2.5	16.5	13.8	12.8	0.36
***	Kotak Flexicap	86.0	55850	1.4	0.6	-0.4	13.5	12.0	13.3	0.33
***	SBI Flexicap	107.7	22685	1.4	0.7	-1.7	9.0	9.2	11.7	0.25
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.9	3639	1.6	0.6	-3.7	12.2	10.4	-	0.28
**	Axis Flexi Cap	27.6	13328	1.5	0.6	2.3	13.1	10.0	-	0.24
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	59.8	13294	1.5	0.7	-4.9	19.0	12.1	12.5	0.30
**	Navi Flexi Cap	24.7	281	2.1	0.5	8.3	11.6	11.6	-	0.32
**	UTI Flexi Cap	316.5	22882	1.7	1.0	-3.6	8.5	6.1	11.7	0.11
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	105.2	1053	1.9	1.0	6.9	12.8	11.1	10.5	0.27
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	20.0	133	2.1	0.7	-2.4	8.2	8.4	-	0.18
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	227.3	349	2.1	2.0	-0.2	12.6	10.7	9.7	0.28
-	Quant Flexi Cap	108.5	7140	1.5	0.6	9.2	17.3	15.5	18.9	0.42
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	296.1	3339	1.7	0.8	3.1	15.9	14.8	14.2	0.40
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	852.3	18194	1.4	0.8	6.1	17.8	16.1	14.6	0.51
-	Invesco India Multicap	131.1	4302	1.6	0.6	-1.3	14.8	12.3	13.5	0.31
-	Mah Manu Multi Cap	38.3	6926	1.6	0.4	6.2	18.3	16.1	-	0.43
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	303.9	54585	1.2	0.6	0.7	16.7	19.1	15.5	0.59
-	Quant Multi Cap	663.0	7761	1.5	0.6	3.7	12.1	12.6	17.3	0.39
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	389.9	2915	2.0	0.9	1.4	14.9	13.4	14.6	0.37
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	208.6	17748	1.4	0.4	6.5	23.3	18.6	18.4	0.52
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	109.4	100858	1.3	0.7	6.4	20.5	20.1	17.8	0.61
*****	Quant Mid Cap	223.0	8138	1.5	0.6	0.9	15.2	15.8	16.9	0.43
*****	Invesco India Midcap	200.3	13767	1.5	0.5	11.1	25.9	20.3	18.7	0.52
*****	Mah Manu Mid Cap	36.6	5076	1.6	0.4	9.2	22.0	18.2	-	0.50
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	98.4	37474	1.3	0.6	-4.4	19.5	22.2	16.7	0.54
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4529.0	49169	1.3	0.6	8.7	22.2	20.1	18.5	0.58
*****	Axis Midcap	120.5	33803	1.3	0.5	6.1	17.7	14.3	16.8	0.40
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	112.3	2513	1.7	0.5	11.1	19.7	15.9	15.6	0.45
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	338.6	7846	1.5	0.9	12.4	23.7	17.8	16.7	0.53
***	Kotak Midcap	147.2	67611	1.4	0.4	8.0	20.7	17.5	17.6	0.49
***	PGIM India Midcap	65.8	10981	1.8	0.6	0.4	12.1	12.0	15.5	0.33
***	SBI Midcap	242.8	24127	1.4	0.7	1.3	13.1	14.7	13.9	0.44
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1499.6	14026	1.7	0.9	8.2	22.0	18.3	15.0	0.52
***	Tata Mid Cap	465.1	5868	1.6	0.6	6.9	19.0	16.0	16.2	0.46
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	842.4	6624	1.6	0.9	6.1	18.4	15.5	13.7	0.43
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2819.5	12490	1.5	0.8	0.5	18.3	14.8	14.4	0.39
**	Taurus Mid Cap	120.3	125	2.1	1.7	-3.9	11.3	11.6	14.3	0.29
**	UTI Mid Cap	310.8	12122	1.9	1.1	1.8	14.1	13.1	13.8	0.35
*	DSP Midcap	154.8	19673	1.4	0.6	4.4	18.1	12.3	14.3	0.33
*	HSBC Midcap	458.0	15352	1.5	0.6	17.2	25.8	18.7	17.1	0.48
*	LIC MF Midcap	30.7	369	2.1	1.1	3.8	18.5	13.8	-	0.36
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	181.7	78407	1.1	0.5	4.7	18.1	19.7	20.7	0.51
*****	Quant Small Cap	286.6	32739	1.3	0.6	9.2	20.6	19.0	20.0	0.46

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	AXIS Small Cap	114.1	29394	1.4	0.5	5.2	16.4	16.3	18.4	0.48
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	54.8	2572	1.7	0.4	15.1	21.7	18.9	-	0.45
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	47.4	13385	1.5	0.4	11.4	24.1	19.8	-	0.50
***	DSP Small Cap	222.6	18358	1.4	0.6	9.8	19.2	18.1	16.6	0.46
***	HDFC Small Cap	139.8	40417	1.5	0.7	-1.8	13.4	15.8	17.2	0.41
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	89.0	9379	1.5	0.7	0.1	12.5	14.4	15.9	0.45
***	Kotak Small Cap	270.2	18691	1.7	0.6	0.9	13.6	13.4	16.6	0.34
***	Sundaram Small Cap	293.8	3872	1.9	0.9	11.5	19.3	17.4	14.7	0.44
***	Tata Small Cap	38.4	12529	1.5	0.4	-6.5	12.1	14.8	-	0.37
***	Union Small Cap	57.7	2268	1.8	0.8	16.3	19.5	17.0	16.5	0.42
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	179.8	14336	1.5	0.8	1.6	16.5	17.3	15.1	0.44
**	HSBC Small Cap	87.6	17830	1.4	0.6	4.2	17.0	17.7	18.2	0.43
**	SBI Small Cap	180.6	40157	1.3	0.6	2.5	13.3	14.0	18.0	0.39
*	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	96.3	5731	1.6	0.8	9.8	16.9	13.1	13.1	0.32
*	LIC MF Small Cap	33.9	743	2.0	0.9	9.4	18.3	17.9	-	0.43
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	40.8	13967	1.5	0.5	2.5	14.3	16.2	-	0.43
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	47.5	6580	1.6	0.4	5.4	17.8	17.3	-	0.46
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
*****	HSBC Value	114.3	14828	1.5	0.6	2.4	19.1	17.3	15.7	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Value	465.0	60198	1.2	0.8	-1.7	15.2	16.7	14.4	0.61
***	Bandhan Value	147.3	9985	1.5	0.6	-1.2	12.0	13.8	14.9	0.41
***	Nippon Ind Value	226.2	8962	1.5	0.9	-1.1	16.9	15.5	15.4	0.45
***	HDFC Value	784.1	7583	1.8	1.0	4.1	17.1	15.2	14.1	0.44
***	JM Value	94.6	823	2.0	1.0	-5.6	14.7	15.5	15.4	0.42
***	Templeton India Value	705.3	2054	1.8	0.8	-3.0	12.5	14.8	14.0	0.45
***	Union Value	29.1	394	2.1	1.1	0.3	14.9	14.2	-	0.42
***	UTI Value	167.4	9440	1.8	1.2	-2.0	14.8	12.7	13.4	0.38
**	Aditya Birla SL Value	136.1	6603	1.6	0.9	7.6	17.6	15.0	12.7	0.37
**	Tata Value	350.4	834	1.5	0.7	-1.3	14.8	14.8	14.1	0.43
**	LIC MF Value	27.9	235	2.1	0.8	14.8	17.1	14.1	-	0.35
*	Quantum Value	119.2	1108	2.1	1.1	-5.8	11.5	10.6	10.9	0.32
-	Groww Value	27.6	71	2.4	1.0	0.5	14.5	12.1	10.4	0.35
-	Sundaram Value	214.1	1300	2.2	1.7	-4.0	8.6	10.0	10.6	0.28
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
*****	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	139.8	16156	1.4	0.6	-1.1	15.6	13.4	15.0	0.40
*****	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	404.5	13143	1.5	0.6	9.1	16.4	15.2	19.3	0.40
*****	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	440.0	31839	1.3	0.8	-1.0	17.4	16.8	14.4	0.52
***	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	154.6	6911	1.6	0.6	0.8	11.1	12.3	14.6	0.35
***	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	164.5	1406	1.8	0.8	1.6	14.4	12.2	15.8	0.33
***	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	179.0	8637	1.5	0.6	0.8	12.2	11.3	14.6	0.32
***	HDFC ELSS Tax Saver	1374.8	15685	1.7	1.1	-3.1	15.2	16.2	13.5	0.53
***	JM ELSS Tax Saver	50.9	232	2.1	0.9	4.5	16.2	15.0	15.9	0.40
***	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	50.8	26049	1.4	0.6	3.0	14.2	12.5	16.7	0.35
***	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	99.3	897	2.0	0.9	3.8	15.9	12.5	12.6	0.33
***	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1439.1	6166	1.6	0.9	-3.9	13.7	13.0	12.4	0.36
***	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	95.3	14064	1.5	1.0	0.5	12.8	12.2	12.6	0.36
***	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	116.6	6197	1.9	0.7	-0.9	12.0	12.3	13.9	0.33
***	Mah Manu ELSS Tax Saver	27.6	884	2.0	0.7	-4.7	9.3	10.3	-	0.27
***	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	55.6	4862	1.6	0.6	4.7	21.9	17.5	16.7	0.42
***	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	118.4	207	2.1	0.9	-5.7	11.4	10.6	10.9	0.33
***	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	501.5	1281	2.2	1.6	-2.5	10.7	11.5	13.1	0.32
***	Tata ELSS	46.7	4597	1.6	0.7	4.1	14.0	13.4	13.6	0.38
***	Union ELSS Tax Saver	65.7	857	2.0	1.2	-0.3	11.9	11.9	12.7	0.33
**	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	115.0	443	2.1	0.7	3.3	13.7	12.2	12.4	0.35
**	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	140.5	4081	1.6	1.0	2.8	16.8	13.6	13.4	0.36
**	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	124.4	2646	1.6	0.8	-2.5	13.0	10.5	13.0	0.25
**	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	131.8	14880	1.5	0.9	2.1	14.8	14.1	10.9	0.42
**	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	34.4	713	2.0	0.8	-2.8	8.7	10.5	12.5	0.28
**	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	203.4	3474	1.9	1.0	-2.6	10.2	9.2	11.7	0.23
*	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	62.1	14467	1.5	0.8	2.2	12.8	9.3	10.6	0.23
*	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	96.5	31869	1.3	0.7	-0.7	10.8	7.4	11.9	0.15
*	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	148.3	1013	1.9	0.9	-4.0	10.6	10.4	11.8	0.28
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	19.0	51	2.4	0.9	-5.8	9.6	9.2	-	0.22
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.9	47	2.1	0.6	-2.1	8.0	8.4	-	0.18
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	178.6	70	2.1	1.5	-5.3	11.2	11.1	12.5	0.33
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	134.0	19996	1.4	0.5	-1.9	15.9	13.8	15.2	0.39
-	Kotak Contra	154.7	5331	1.9	0.7	2.0	16.7	15.2	15.8	0.44
-	SBI Contra	377.1	47362	1.3	0.6	-3.0	13.3	16.4	15.4	0.57
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	53.6	6630	1.6	0.6	1.7	18.3	18.7	15.3	0.65
***	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	135.9	2285	1.7	1.0	-2.7	13.3	12.9	14.8	0.49
***	LIC MF Dividend Yield	32.4	718	2.1	0.7	4.3	19.5	16.0	-	0.45
***	UTI Dividend Yield	176.8	3479	2.0	1.5	-1.1	15.5	12.9	13.8	0.41
**	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	450.6	1437	1.8	1.1	-0.4	14.5	13.9	12.6	0.43
*	Sundaram Dividend Yield	131.2	820	2.3	1.1	-3.8	11.2	10.8	13.8	0.34
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Consumption	190.1	2422	1.7	0.6	-5.0	10.8	13.5	12.5	0.38
***	Baroda BNP Paribas India Cons	30.2	1432	1.8	0.6	-3.7	10.0	11.2	-	0.29
***	Canara Robeco Consumption	107.0	1913	1.8	0.7	-3.4	11.1	12.4	14.8	0.32
***	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	206.7	5990	1.6	0.7	-4.4	9.8	11.0	13.5	0.28
***	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	91.8	4550	1.6	0.4	-0.9	10.8	13.2	15.1	0.34
***	SBI Consumption Opport	286.9	2906	0.8	0.3	-8.4	7.7	12.6	13.3	0.35
***	Tata India Consumer	46.6	2703	1.7	0.6	6.1	15.2	14.4	16.1	0.37
**	Sundaram Consumption	92.0	1422	2.1	1.3	-5.8	10.1	11.1	11.5	0.29
**	UTI India Consumer	57.3	689	2.0	1.3	0.1	11.0	10.2	11.0	0.24
*	Mah Manu Consumption	21.7	494	2.1	0.6	-3.0	9.5	10.8	-	0.27
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
*****	Sundaram Fin Serv Oppo	111.1	1681	2.1	0.8	4.9	14.5	14.5	14.3	0.38
*****	Invesco India Fin Serv	150.7	1811	1.8	0.7	8.1	18.6	15.3	15.4	0.38
*****	Nippon Ind Banking & Fin Serv	659.6	7789	1.5	0.8	2.9	13.8	14.5	13.8	0.37
***	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	64.5	3676	1.6	0.9	3.9	12.2	10.2	12.7	0.28
***	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	134.2	11034	1.5	0.9	-1.1	11.0	12.5	12.6	0.26
***	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	44.5	10845	1.5	0.7	3.0	16.2	13.2	15.2	0.33
***	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	44.8	3171	1.7	0.5	1.4	12.9	12.7	14.3	0.31
**	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	49.9	4121	2.1	0.7	2.6	14.1	12.4	12.2	0.29
**	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	199.4	1430	2.0	0.9	3.2	13.4	12.4	11.0	0.30
*	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	22.0	269	2.1	1.0	3.0	8.6	10.9	9.0	0.25
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	54.1	12	2.1	1.4	-1.0	9.1	10.8	12.4	0.26
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
*****	SBI Technology Opport	188.3	4018	1.6	0.8	-14.0	8.6	8.1	15.3	0.19
*****	ICICI Pru Technology	172.2	12547	1.5	0.9	-15.8	7.4	5.8	15.4	0.12
***	Franklin Ind Technology	455.4	1583	1.7	0.9	-12.5	12.1	8.3	14.8	0.18
**	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	146.8	3589	1.6	0.8	-15.8	5.1	5.1	14.9	0.10
*	Tata Digital India	39.5	9196	1.5	0.5	-18.2	5.8	5.4	14.6	0.11
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru P.H.D	43.6	6625	1.6	0.9	9.7	25.6	16.0	-	0.54
*****	DSP Healthcare	44.3	3309	1.7	0.5	12.5	22.7	14.8	-	0.45
**	Mirae Asset Healthcare	44.3	3253	1.7	0.4	15.5	24.0	14.2	-	0.45
***	Nippon Ind Pharma	562.3	9044	1.5	0.8	9.2	21.0	12.8	15.0	0.40
***	SBI Healthcare Opport	498.7	4998	1.6	0.8	15.3	24.3	16.5	13.5	0.56
**	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	33.0	1455	1.8	0.7	8.6	21.6	13.5	13.1	0.42
*	UTI Healthcare	330.2	1308	2.0	0.9	15.0	26.0	14.6	13.6	0.45
-	LIC MF Healthcare	32.6	93	2.1	1.0	11.7	22.2	11.0	-	0.31
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
*****	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	41.9	1695	1.8	0.6	8.3	18.9	14.8	-	0.42
*****	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	407.7	51481	1.2	0.8	3.7	15.9	16.8	15.3	0.72
*****	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	469.5	2145	1.7	0.6	9.9	14.2	13.6	15.8	0.44
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Aggressive Hyb	28.0	1246	1.9	0.5	-0.5	11.1	9.9	-	0.32
*****	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	64.7	3784	1.6	0.4	1.0	13.2	13.1	12.5	0.50
*****	JM Aggressive Hybrid	117.9	692	2.0	0.7	-3.8	13.9	13.2	11.9	0.41
*****	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	65.7	8962	1.5	0.4	4.3	13.6	12.3	12.7	0.42
*****	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	409.6	6184	1.9	1.2	0.2	12.5	12.4	11.7	0.47
**	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	27.7	2184	1.7	0.5	7.1	14.3	12.0	-	0.39
**	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	367.3	11142	1.5	0.5	1.0	11.1	10.0	12.2	0.30

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year %ann	3 Month %ann	6 Month %ann	1 Year CAGR	

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid	2134.9	1153	0.3	0.2	6.4	5.9	6.3	6.0	-
- Aditya Birla SL Liquid	448.0	63687	0.3	0.2	7.3	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- Axis Liquid	3097.2	44866	0.2	0.1	7.3	6.5	6.8	6.3	-
- Bandhan Liquid	3355.4	15800	0.2	0.1	7.0	6.3	6.6	6.2	-
- Bank of India Liquid	3203.4	1339	0.1	0.1	7.3	6.4	6.7	6.3	1.90
- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3194.0	8087	0.2	0.1	7.1	6.3	6.6	6.2	0.90
- Canara Robeco Liquid	3346.3	5182	0.1	0.1	7.0	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- DSP Liquidity	3970.0	19371	0.2	0.1	7.2	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- Edelweiss Liquid	3557.3	12259	0.2	0.1	7.2	6.5	6.7	6.3	-
- Groww Liquid	2688.2	279	0.2	0.1	7.2	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- HDFC Liquid	5453.5	65878	0.3	0.2	7.1	6.3	6.7	6.3	-
- HSBC Liquid	2771.2	19663	0.2	0.1	7.2	6.4	6.7	6.2	-
- ICICI Pru Liquid	411.4	54543	0.3	0.2	7.3	6.4	6.6	6.2	-
- Invesco India Liquid	3821.4	16797	0.2	0.1	7.3	6.5	6.7	6.3	-
- ITI Liquid	1444.6	50	0.2	0.1	6.7	6.0	6.2	6.0	-
- JM Liquid	75.8	1759	0.2	0.1	7.1	6.3	6.5	6.2	-
- Kotak Liquid	5617.1	39817	0.3	0.2	7.2	6.4	6.6	6.2	-
- LIC MF Liquid	5025.3	13416	0.2	0.1	7.3	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- Mahi Manu Liquid	1808.8	1019	0.2	0.1	7.0	6.3	6.6	6.3	-
- Mirae Asset Liquid	2912.7	10973	0.2	0.1	6.9	6.2	6.5	6.2	-
- Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.6	930	0.4	0.2	6.6	5.9	6.1	5.8	-
- Navi Liquid	30.1	75	0.2	0.2	6.2	5.7	5.8	5.7	-
- Nippon Ind Liquid	6783.7	35870	0.3	0.2	7.2	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- Parag Parikh Liquid	1541.2	5575	0.2	0.1	7.1	6.3	6.7	6.2	-
- PGIM India Liquid	362.0	748	0.2	0.1	7.2	6.5	6.7	6.3	-
- Quant Liquid	43.7	1255	0.5	0.3	6.0	5.5	5.8	5.7	-
- Quantum Liquid	37.1	531	0.3	0.2	6.2	5.7	5.9	5.7	-
- SBI Liquid	4343.7	71448	0.3	0.2	7.3	6.4	6.7	6.2	-
- Sundaram Liquid	2449.0	6365	0.4	0.1	7.2	6.3	6.5	6.2	-
- Tata Liquid	4378.4	22044	0.3	0.2	7.1	6.3	6.6	6.3	-
- Union Liquid	2674.9	6650	0.2	0.1	7.1	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- UTI Liquid	456.2	27632	0.3	0.2	7.1	6.4	6.7	6.3	-
- WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1493.2	640	0.3	0.2	6.9	6.2	6.5	6.1	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1464.5	8574	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Axis Overnight	1440.6	8216	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Bandhan Overnight	1445.2	1260	0.1	0.0	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Bank of India Overnight	1385.6	43	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.8	5.5	5.6	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1428.2	776	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Canara Robeco Overnight	1408.6	304	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- DSP Overnight	1454.6	3222	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Edelweiss Overnight	1407.9	143	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Franklin Ind Overnight	1420.2	799	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
- Groww Overnight	1397.9	95	0.2	0.1	5.0	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- HDFC Overnight	4006.6	9991	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- HSBC Overnight	1417.3	3644	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- ICICI Pru Overnight	1462.8	10066	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Invesco India Overnight	1375.2	572	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- ITI Overnight	1372.5	21	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
- JM Overnight	1377.8	81	0.1	0.1	5.0	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
- Kotak Overnight	1447.6	6260	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
- LIC MF Overnight	1404.4	940	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Mahi Manu Overnight	1404.1	62	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- Mirae Asset Overnight	1392.4	1130	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- Nippon Ind Overnight	145.7	6785	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
- PGIM India Overnight	1401.9	79	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
- SBI Overnight	4381.4	26839	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- Sundaram Overnight	1440.5	854	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.0	5.2	-
- Tata Overnight	1430.5	3893	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.2	-
- Union Overnight	1427.7	550	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	-
- UTI Overnight	3697.7	4264	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS

- Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	28.2	26646	0.9	0.3	6.6	5.8	5.9	5.8	-
- Axis Arbitrage	19.8	10362	0.9	0.3	6.4	5.6	5.9	5.8	-
- Bandhan Arbitrage	34.3	8190	0.9	0.3	6.2	5.5	5.6	5.6	-
- Bank of India Arbitrage	14.6	48	0.9	0.4	4.5	5.0	5.3	5.4	-
- Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	17.0	1147	1.0	0.3	5.9	5.3	5.4	5.5	-
- DSP Arbitrage	15.8	6382	0.9	0.3	6.2	5.5	5.8	5.7	-
- Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.6	15062	0.9	0.3	6.7	5.9	5.9	5.9	-
- HDFC Arbitrage	32.5	23772	0.9	0.4	6.7	5.9	6.1	6.0	-
- HSBC Arbitrage	20.1	2944	0.7	0.2	6.4	5.7	6.0	5.9	-
- ICICI Pru Arbitrage	36.4	33423	0.8	0.3	6.8	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
- Invesco India Arbitrage	33.9	28526	0.9	0.3	6.6	5.9	6.0	6.0	-
- ITI Arbitrage	13.7	72	0.8	0.2	4.9	4.7	5.7	5.7	-
- JM Arbitrage	34.5	383	0.9	0.4	5.8	5.5	5.5	5.6	-
- Kotak Arbitrage	39.8	72409	1.0	0.4	6.3	5.8	6.0	5.9	-
- LIC MF Arbitrage	14.7	243	0.8	0.3	6.7	5.9	6.1	5.8	-
- Mahi Manu Arbitrage	13.0	126	1.0	0.3	5.3	5.1	5.3	5.4	-
- Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.8	3737	0.8	0.1	6.4	5.8	5.8	5.8	-
- Nippon Ind Arbitrage	28.2	16638	0.9	0.3	6.5	5.9	5.9	5.8	0.60
- PGIM India Arbitrage	19.4	94	1.0	0.4	6.7	6.1	6.0	5.6	-
- SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.9	45923	0.8	0.4	6.2	5.7	6.0	5.9	-
- Sundaram Arbitrage	15.3	650	1.0	0.2	6.3	5.8	6.2	5.9	-
- Tata Arbitrage	15.2	24026	0.9	0.3	6.4	5.6	5.9	5.9	-
- Union Arbitrage	14.9	246	0.9	0.3	6.6	5.8	5.8	5.7	-
- UTI Arbitrage	37.2	11324	1.8	1.3	6.4	5.7	5.9	5.9	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

DEBT FUNDS

DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS

***** Aditya Birla SL Savings	584.7	17816	0.5	0.3	6.2	7.2	7.3	6.4	13.27
***** Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1643.7	623	0.4	0.2	6.2	7.0	7.1	6.3	-
***** Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4286.5	10200	1.0	0.3	6.1	6.7	6.8	6.1	24.18
***** Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.2	4099	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
***** ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.5	14352	0.7	0.3	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	11.94
***** Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1395.6	1467	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.1	7.2	6.3	9.78
***** UTI Ultra Short Duration	4499.2	3146	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	6.5	10.48
***** Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.6	4949	1.1	0.3	5.7	6.5	6.6	5.8	13.28
*** DSP Ultra Short	3613.0	3905	0.9	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.7	5.8	7.75
*** HDFC Ultra Short Term	16.1	15950	0.7	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	6.38
*** HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1442.7	3621	0.3	0.1	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.2	-
*** Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2868.0	1002	0.7	0.2	6.0	6.8	6.9	5.9	0.30
*** Kotak Savings	45.5	14181	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.8	6.0	7.02
*** Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1463.5	196	0.6	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.9	6.0	1.28
*** SBI Ultra Short Duration	6359.2	11408	0.5	0.3	6.1	6.8	7.0	6.1	9.41
*** WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1442.5	535	1.0	0.5	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.7	-
*** BOI Ultra Short Duration	3354.7	148	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.7	7.45
*** LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1400.5	441	1.2	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.4	5.6	1.15
*** PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	36.1	166	0.9	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.4	5.7	3.02
*** Tata Ultra Short Term	15.1	5267	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.6	5.8	10.46
*** Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	4027.9	503	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.4	6.5	5.6	-
*** Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.4	378	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.5	5.7	5.0	-
*** Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2830.4	1972	1.4	0.2	5.1	5.9	6.0	5.2	1.58

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS

***** ICICI Pru Savings	580.6	22339	0.5	0.4	6.3	7.3	7.5	6.6	7.85
***** UTI Low Duration	3781.0	2460	0.4	0.3	6.1	7.2	7.2	7.4	7.79
***** Axis Treasury Advantage	3294.4	4650	0.6	0.3	6.0	7.1	7.2	6.3	6.95
***** DSP Low Duration	21.1	4244	0.5	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.9	6.1	-
***** HDFC Low Duration	61.3	18242	1.1	0.5	5.7	6.8	6.9	6.1	13.36
***** HSBC Low Duration	30.5	915	0.8	0.3	5.9	7.6	7.5	6.4	10.77
*** Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	695.0	9775	1.0	0.4	5.4	6.5	6.6	5.9	13.19
*** Bandhan Low Duration	41.0	5986	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.9	6.9	6.0	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	

*** Canara Robeco Savings	44.8	1101	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.9	7.0	6.1	-
*** Invesco India Low Duration	4020.0	1663	0.5	0.3	5.8	6.9	7.0	6.0	4.65
*** JM Low Duration	39.3	219	0.8	0.3	5.7	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.42
*** Nippon Ind Low Duration	3978.0	7379	0.8	0.3	5.8	6.9	6.9	6.1	9.03
*** SBI Low Duration	3699.8	13394	0.8	0.4	5.4	6.6	6.7	5.9	4.01
*** Tata Treasury Advantage	4182.3	2051	0.5	0.2	5.9	6.9	7.0	6.1	7.13
*** Kotak Low Duration	3542.5	11523	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.7	6.8	5.9	10.97
*** Mahi Manu Low Duration	1733.9	561	0.9	0.3	5.7	6.7	6.7	5.8	13.17
*** Mirae Asset Low Duration	2397.3	2085	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.8	6.8	5.9	6.25
*** Sundaram Low Duration	3655.1	385	1.1	0.4	5.2	6.5	6.6	5.8	2.51
*** Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.5	274	0.9	0.2	5.5	6.6	6.6	5.7	1.83
*** LIC MF Low Duration	42.0	1706	0.4	0.2	5.7	6.7	6.7	5.8	6.10

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS

***** Nippon Ind Money Market

HDFC Bank rooted in corporate governance principles, says interim part-time Chairman

PROCESS ORIENTED. Any matter that warrants review or attention will continue to receive careful consideration: Keki Mistry

Our Bureau
Mumbai

HDFC Bank remains firmly rooted in strong corporate governance principles and values, even as many of the merger related synergies are progressing well, said interim part-time Chairman Keki M Mistry.

These observation comes in the backdrop of Atanu Chakraborty alleging that “certain happenings and practices within the bank, that I have observed over last two years, are not in congruence with my personal Values and Ethics” in his resignation letter of March 18, 2026. In the letter, Chakraborty said: “I joined the board of HDFC Bank in May 2021. My tenure on the Board saw momentous events like merger of the bank with HDFC Ltd that created a conglomerate under the Bank. This strategic initiative made HDFC Bank the second largest bank in the country.

“We remain committed to maintaining the highest standards of transparency, accountability and oversight

KEKI M MISTRY
Interim part-time Chairman,
HDFC Bank

Though the benefits of merger are yet to fully fructify.”

Mistry took on the mantle as an interim part-time Chairman of HDFC Bank with effect from March 19, 2026.

“As always, we remain fully committed to maintaining the highest standards of transparency, accountability and oversight. Any matter that warrants review or attention will continue to receive careful consideration, guided by



regulatory filing, said that the legal review into Chakraborty's resignation letter did not find any irregularities.

DETAILED STUDY

The external law firms scrutinised thousands of documents, including minutes and agenda papers of board and committee meetings for two years preceding Chakraborty's resignation, per the filing. They also interviewed Independent Directors, Committee Chairpersons, the Managing Director & CEO, and senior management overseeing control and assurance functions.

Despite repeated requests, Chakraborty did not participate in the review process, according to the law firm's report.

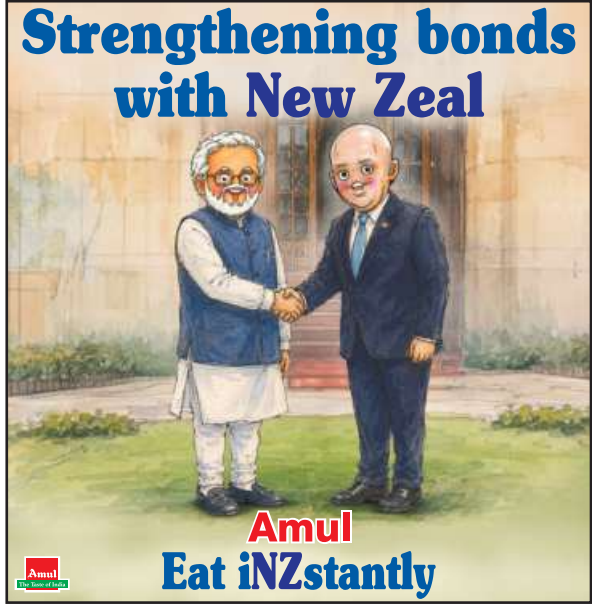
In his message to shareholders, Sashidhar Jagdishan, MD and CEO, said: “The bank on June 26, 2026, shared the findings of the external law firms which, in essence was that Mr. Chakraborty's statement in his resignation letter and its im-

plications were not substantiated by the record reviewed and witness interviews.”

MEGA MERGER

Referring to the merger of HDFC with and into HDFC Bank, which was concluded three year ago, Mistry emphasised that this transformed HDFC Bank Group into one of the leading financial services conglomerates in India. At the heart of this merger has been marrying the expertise of the home loan product with the bank's reach and technology.

“I am happy to say that many of the merger related synergies are progressing well. Cross-sell is at a healthy level and we continue to work towards realising its potential on an ongoing basis over the long term. “I remain highly optimistic about the long term prospects of the housing sector in India, which will have a positive cascading effect on lending institutions,” he said.



IEA sees India's natural gas demand dropping 8% in 2026

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India's natural gas demand is expected to fall roughly 8 per cent y-o-y in 2026, with the fertilizer sector likely to post the steepest decline, as the West Asia conflict and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz almost choked off half of the liquefied natural gas (LNG) imports from the region.

The International Energy Agency (IEA) in its latest Q3 2026 gas market report anticipates that the world's fourth largest LNG importer's natural gas demand is likely to decline around 8 per cent y-o-y in 2026.

However, the IEA pointed out that despite a significant softening in gas demand, India's weak domestic gas production kept LNG imports up on the year.

SOFTENING DEMAND

The West Asia conflict has significantly altered, albeit temporarily, India's LNG consumption dynamics, and supply sources. For instance, in February 2026, the IEA projected India's total natural gas consumption to hit 103 billion cubic meters per year by 2030.

“This represents a nearly 7 per cent annual average growth rate between 2023 and 2030, far in excess of the previous five years' CAGR of less than 2 per cent,” it had said.

Between January and April 2026, India's natural gas demand declined 4 per cent y-o-y, reflecting strong price sensitivity across key consuming sectors. Demand trends diverged by end use.

“Fertilizer production recorded the largest absolute decline, falling more than 0.4 bcm or 7 per cent y-o-y, despite its designation as critical to agricultural productivity and food security under the Natural Gas (Supply Regulation) Order 2026, issued by



the government in early March 2026, shortly after the de facto closure of the Hormuz, IEA pointed out.

PETROCHEM DOWN

Petrochemical output also contracted sharply, by 21 per cent y-o-y. By contrast, gas use in the residential and commercial sectors — mainly city gas distribution for compressed natural gas (CNG) in transport and piped natural gas (PNG) for households and small industry — increased around 12 per cent y-o-y.

The IEA projected that Asia's natural gas demand is expected to decline by 0.5 per cent in 2026 as higher LNG prices spur gas-to-coal switching in power sector and lead to lower operating rates across gas- and energy intensive industries.

The IEA noted that India's domestic gas production remains on a declining trend, recording 22 consecutive months of year-on-year contraction since July 2024 and falling 4 per cent y-o-y in 2026.

Against this backdrop, LNG imports totalled around 11 bcm over the period, up 1 per cent y-o-y despite the West Asia supply disruption, it added.

Monthly inflows were volatile, with strong deliveries in January, followed by declines in March (down 16 per cent y-o-y) and April (down 7 per cent y-o-y) amid the onset of the Middle East supply disruption, before rebounding in May (up 7 per cent y-o-y), it pointed out.

IREDA classifies loan accounts of Gensol Engg, arm as fraud; reports to RBI

M Ramesh
Chennai

State-run Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency (IREDA) has classified the loan accounts of Gensol Engineering Ltd and its subsidiary, Gensol EV Lease Ltd, as fraud and reported the matter to the Reserve Bank of India , escalating regulatory action against the embattled renewable energy company.

In a stock exchange filing on Friday, IREDA said the accounts had been declared as fraud in accordance with the RBI's Master Direction on Fraud Risk Management for non-banking financial companies. The lender said the action follows its earlier disclosures relating to the borrowers.

MISAPPROPRIATION

IREDA said Gensol Engineering's account, with outstanding dues of ₹453.77 crore, has been classified as fraud on grounds of alleged “misappropriation and criminal breach of trust” and “forgery with the intention to commit fraud by making false documents and/or electronic records”.

Its subsidiary, Gensol EV Lease Ltd, with outstanding dues of ₹218.97 crore, has been classified as fraud for alleged misappropriation and criminal breach of trust. The lender has already made provisions equivalent to 85 per cent of the outstanding amount in both accounts as of March 31, 2026.

The declaration marks the



latest development in the widening regulatory action against Gensol and its promoters. In April 2025, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) issued an interim order alleging diversion of company funds, falsification of documents submitted to lenders and serious corporate governance lapses.

FALSE DOCUMENTS

SEBI's investigation was triggered after credit rating agencies CARE Ratings and ICRA downgraded Gensol's debt to default grade in March 2025, citing delays in debt servicing and concerns that documents furnished by the company regarding its repayment record had apparently been falsified. The regulator subsequently found *prima facie* evidence that ‘conduct letters’ purportedly issued by IREDA and Power Finance Corporation had been forged.

Separately, IREDA has initiated recovery proceedings against the Gensol entities before the Debt Recovery Tribunal and also filed insolvency proceedings against Gensol Engineering to recover its dues.

15 Indian tourists feared dead in Vietnam boat capsize accident; search ops on

Press Trust of India
Hanoi (Vietnam)

Fifteen people, including Indian tourists, are feared dead in a boat capsize accident near Vietnam's Phu Quoc Island on Saturday, according to a local media report.

According to Vietnamese news portal *VN Express International*, the speedboat was carrying 32 Indian tourists and four crew members from Hon May Rut to An Thoi Port when it capsized about 400 metres off Hon May Rut Ngoai, throwing everyone on board into the sea.

Citing initial information from authorities in the Phu Quoc Special Economic Zone, the news portal said nearby tourist boats rushed to assist before border guards, the navy, the



MARINE DISASTER. Vietnam Coast Guard Region 4 Command personnel rescue the tourists after boat capsized near Vietnam's Phu Quoc Island **ANI**

coast guard and other forces joined the search-and-rescue operation.

A total of 15 people were killed, it said. But the Indian mission is yet to share details about the deaths.

“In a tragic incident, a boat carrying several Indian tourists has cap-

sized near Phu Quoc Island in Vietnam,” the Embassy said in a post on X. It said control rooms have been established at the Consulate General of India in Ho Chi Minh City and at the Embassy in Hanoi to provide information and assistance.

DMart board approves ₹1,000 crore NCD issue; Q1 net rises 12.8% on higher revenue

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Avenue Supermarts Ltd, which operates the DMart supermarket chain, on Saturday approved raising up to ₹1,000 crore through non-convertible debentures (NCDs) in one or more tranches on a private placement basis, even as it reported a 12.8 per cent year-on-year rise in standalone profit after tax (PAT) to ₹936 crore for the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The company, however, did not disclose the proposed use of the proceeds from the debt issue.

Revenue for the quarter rose 15.1 per cent to ₹18,343 crore from



₹15,932 crore a year earlier, while the earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation (EBITDA) increased 16.3 per cent to ₹1,527 crore. The EBITDA margin improved marginally to 8.3 per cent from 8.2 per cent, while basic earnings per share rose to ₹14.35 from ₹12.75.

On a consolidated basis, revenue

increased to ₹18,795 crore from ₹16,360 crore, while the net profit rose to ₹860 crore from ₹773 crore.

OLDER STORES

Anshul Asawa, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer, said same-store (like-for-like) sales growth at stores older than two years moderated to 5.5 per cent during the quarter from 7.1 per cent a year ago.

“In large metros, growth in older stores which have significantly higher revenue per square foot was flat this quarter, while stores in non-metros continue to grow well,” Asawa said.

The company added three stores during the quarter, taking its network to 503 stores with a retail business area of 20.7 million square feet.

Kharif sowing drives tractor sales past one lakh units in June; M&M leads

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The tractor retail market crossed the one-lakh unit mark in June, with retail sales rising 25.3 per cent year-on-year to 1,00,818 units from 80,456 units in the corresponding month last year, according to the Federation of Automobile Dealers Association (FADA).

All major players reported y-o-y growth on the onset of the kharif sowing season.

Market leader Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M) further consolidated its dominance across both its Mahindra and Swaraj brands.

M&M's tractor division retained the top position with retail sales of 24,327 units, up from 17,518 units in June 2025, increasing its market share to 24.13 per cent from 21.77 per cent.

Its Swaraj division, at No 2, posted strong growth, selling 18,860 units against 14,292 units a year earlier, raising its market share to 18.71 per cent from 17.76

On a growth path (in units)				
OEM	June 2025	Market share (%)	June 2026	Market share (%)
Mahindra & Mahindra (Tractor)	17,518	21.8	24,327	24.1
Mahindra & Mahindra (Swaraj Division)	14,292	17.8	18,860	18.7
International Tractors	10,432	13.0	13,184	13.1
TAFE	9,816	12.2	12,069	12.0
Escorts Kubota (Agri Machinery Group)	8,449	10.5	10,371	10.3

Source: FADA Research

per cent, according to FADA data. Together, Mahindra's two brands accounted for 43,187 tractors, representing a combined market share of 42.84 per cent, reinforcing the group's leadership in the domestic tractor market.

International Tractors that own Sonalika and Solis brands took the No 3 position, selling 13,184 tractors in June (10,432).

Chennai-based TAFE Ltd remained the fourth-largest player and Escorts Kubota's Agri Machinery Group was in the fifth position, according to FADA.

Other manufacturers,

John Deere India, and Eicher Tractors registered positive growth.

RURAL SENTIMENT UP

The June retail data indicate sustained momentum in the farm equipment sector, supported by healthy agricultural activity and improving rural sentiment. The strong performance of the leading tractor makers also reflects continued demand from farmers ahead of the peak sowing season.

Escorts Kubota Ltd Agri Machinery Business in its monthly bulletin said growth momentum remained positive in June,

supported by improved performance across both wholesale and retail segments.

So far water reservoirs have been able to support agricultural activity and rural sentiment, but the deficient monsoon and emerging impact of El Nino conditions remain key monitorables, it added.

Hemal Thakkar, Senior Director and Senior Practice Leader, Crisil Intelligence, said tractor retail sales witnessed strong growth in June, supported by the commencement of land preparation and sowing activities for the kharif season, which boosted rural demand across key agricultural markets. Improved cash flow among farmers following the rabi harvest further aided the buying sentiment.

Additionally, retail volumes were supported by deliveries under the ongoing State subsidies with release of agro permits in Odisha and start of deliveries under the subsidy portal in Gujarat, Thakkar said.

Indian Navy protected ₹9,000 crore worth cargo during W. Asia crisis: Rajnath Singh

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Navy successfully evolved as a robust guardian of the nation's financial stability during the West Asia crisis, safeguarding 19 vessels carrying goods worth over ₹9,000 crore, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh has said.

Singh made the remarks in his address at the official commissioning ceremony of the indigenously-built advanced stealth frigate *INS Mahendragiri* at the Naval Dockyard in Visakhapatnam on Saturday.

“Recent events have once again proven how essential a capable and responsive Navy is for any nation. After the conflict began in West Asia, the Indian Navy, through ‘Operation Urja Suraksha’, safely escorted 18 merchant vessels carrying essential cargo worth more than ₹9,000 crore. In other words, our Navy has emerged not only as a fighting force but also as a strong protector of India's economic interests,” the Minister said.

RISING NAVAL POWER

The Navy inducted the *INS Mahendragiri* into its Eastern Fleet, which Singh described as a reflection of India's growing self-reliance in shipbuilding, underpinned by exceptional design capabilities, manufacturing excellence, the rapid



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh at the commissioning ceremony of frigate *INS Mahendragiri* **PTI**

growth of the naval-industrial ecosystem, and its ability to deliver state-of-the-art platforms in a timely manner. He also stated the Navy has emerged as most trusted partner in the Indo-Pacific.

‘TRUSTED PARTNER’

“In today's times, the eyes of the entire world are on the Indo-Pacific region, and India's role in this region is very significant... We desire security and development for everyone in this region. India has emerged as a ‘net security provider’ and a trusted partner across the entire

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